USER MANUAL

MES AR Automation

How to run the monthly accounts receivable cycle, what the system does on its own, and how to test it

FOR	The MES Group Accounts Receivable, CSD and management teams
WEB ADDRESS	mes-ar-automation.vercel.app
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1 What the system does

MES AR Automation chases unpaid rent and charges for MES Group. You upload the accounts receivable report from NetSuite, and the system works out who owes what and since when. It sends each tenant the right reminder on the right day, tells you who to phone, and works out the late payment fee. Most of this happens on its own, every morning at 9am Singapore time.

1.1 The monthly cycle in one picture

Every bill has its own clock. The clock starts on the bill's billing date, which is the Date column of the AR report. The picture follows one bill raised on 15 August. A bill raised on any other day goes through the same steps, counted from its own date.

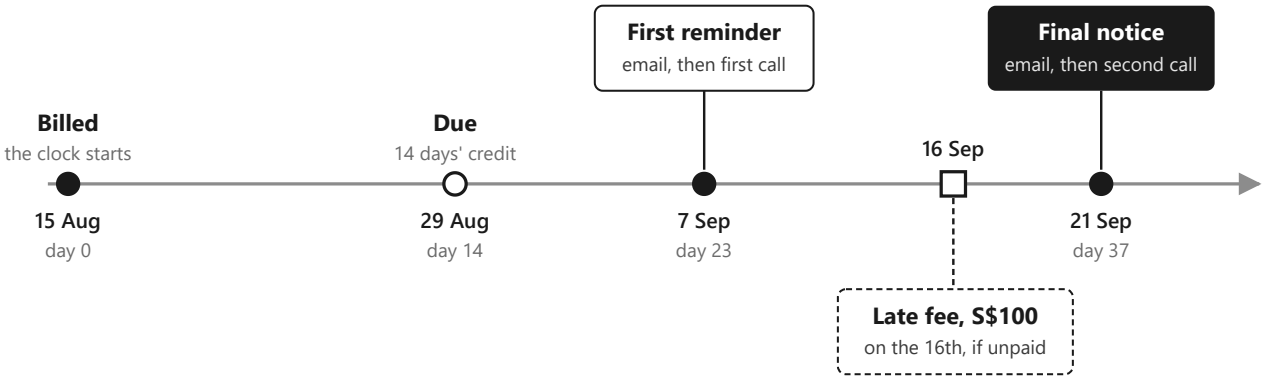


Figure 1.1 One bill's journey. The 23 and 37 days, the 14 days and the S$100 are the standard settings, and an administrator can change each of them under Settings.

1.2 What you do, and what the system does

You	The system, on its own
Upload the AR report from NetSuite after each billing run and when payments are posted.	Reads every invoice line and groups each tenant's bills by billing date. A tenant who has gone from the report is treated as paid.
Upload the client contact list when addresses change.	Matches each address to its tenant by company name, so reminders can be emailed.
Nothing. The 9am run starts by itself every day.	Sends the first reminder for every bill that is 23 days old that morning, and the final notice for every bill that is 37 days old. A tenant due two letters on the same day gets one email.
Phone the tenants on the Call List and log each call.	Lists who is due a first call (after the first reminder) and a second call (after the final notice). Keeps any promise to pay and flags it if the date passes unpaid.

Check Late Payment Fees after the 16th and download the listing for the AR team.	On the 16th, raises S$100 (before GST) once per tenant on bills more than 14 days past their due date. Tenants on GIRO are left out.
Email the month's reports and download the NetSuite file from Reports and Export.	Builds the reports and the file from the same figures every screen uses.
Read the Activity Log when something looks wrong.	Records every letter, call, promise, fee, upload and change of setting, with who did it and when, and what each 9am run did.

1.3 The rules it follows

These rules hold on every screen and in the 9am run. Chapter 12 explains each one in more detail.

- **Each billing date is chased on its own.** A tenant billed on 15 August and again on 1 September gets letters for both. Each letter asks for that date's total and does not list the invoices.
- **A letter goes on its day.** If the 9am run could not send on day 23, for example because no mailbox was connected, the letter is not sent late. Settings can allow a few days' grace.
- **A tenant missing from a newer report has paid.** They stop getting letters, leave the Call List, and any promise they made is marked "Paid, no longer owing".
- **A promise to pay holds the letters.** While a promise date has not passed, the tenant gets no reminder and is not on the list to phone.
- **Ad hoc bills** are bills dated on any day other than the 15th, MES's regular billing day. They are chased the same way and marked Ad hoc so you can tell them apart.
- **An old report still runs.** If the newest report is more than 16 days old, the 9am run carries on and the Activity Log shows a warning.
- **Nothing reaches a tenant unless sending is switched on and a mailbox is connected.** Settings, Mailbox shows which is the case.

GOOD TO KNOW

The system never changes NetSuite and never takes money from a bank account. Letters, calls and promises go back into NetSuite through the file on Reports and Export, and late fees through the listing on Late Payment Fees.

2 Signing in, the menu and who can do what

Everyone at MES who uses the system has their own login. What you see in the menu depends on your role, so two people can open the system and see different screens. This chapter covers signing in, finding your way around, and what each role is allowed to do.

2.1 Signing in and out

Open **mes-ar-automation.vercel.app** in any browser. It works the same in Chrome, Edge and Safari, on a computer or a phone.

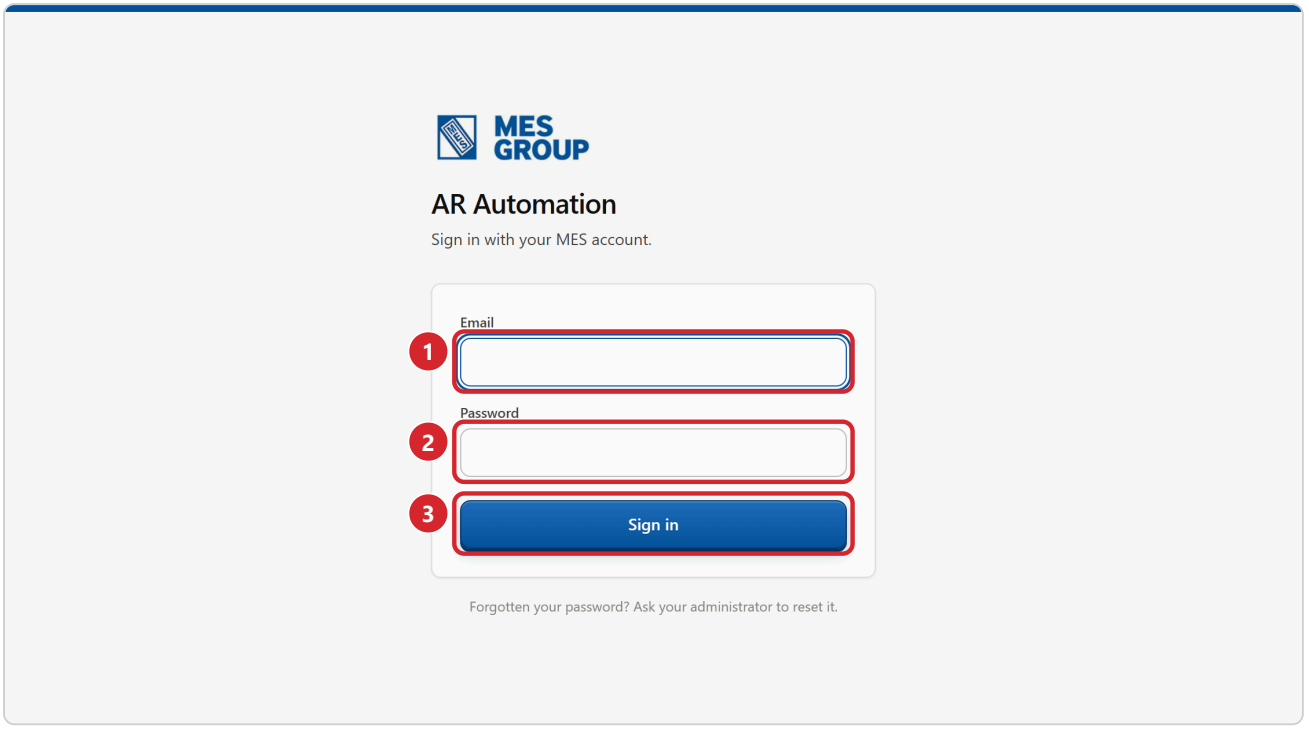


Figure 2.1 The sign-in page.

1. Your email address. This is your username.
2. Your password.
3. Press **Sign in**. You land on Outstanding Balances.

If you have forgotten your password, ask an administrator. Passwords are never sent by email.

To sign out, press the arrow button at the bottom of the menu, next to your name. Sign out when you finish on a shared computer.

2.2 The menu

The menu on the left is grouped the way the month runs. The cycle holds the screens you use every month, Review holds the reports, and Admin holds the settings.

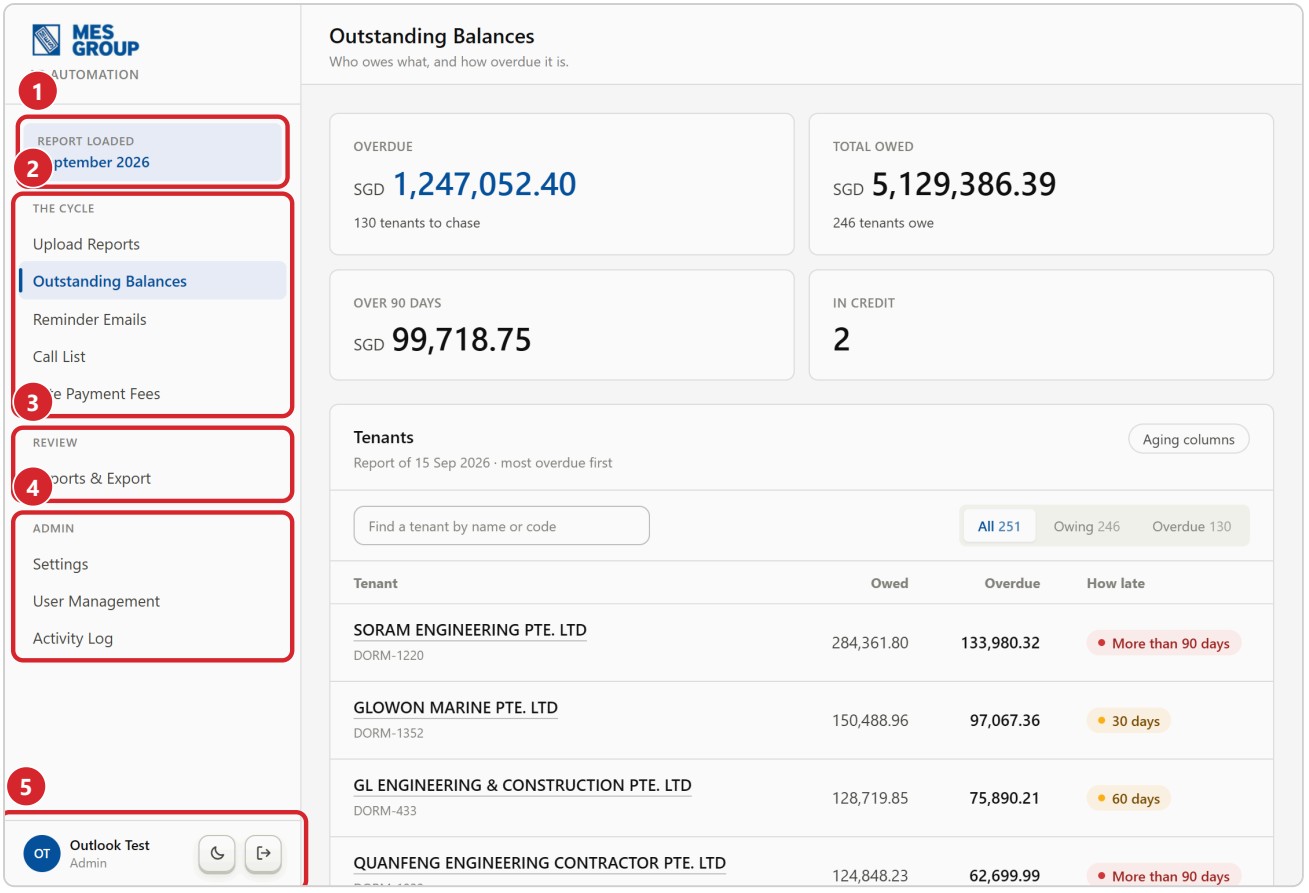


Figure 2.2 The menu, as an Admin sees it.

1. The month of the AR report every screen is reading. If it is not the month you expect, upload the newest report.
2. The cycle: Upload Reports, Outstanding Balances, Reminder Emails, Call List and Late Payment Fees.
3. Review: Reports and Export.
4. Admin: Settings, User Management and the Activity Log.
5. Who is signed in and their role. The moon button switches between light and dark, and the arrow signs you out.

Hover over a menu item to see a one-line description of the screen. A tenant's name anywhere in the system is a link to that tenant's own page.

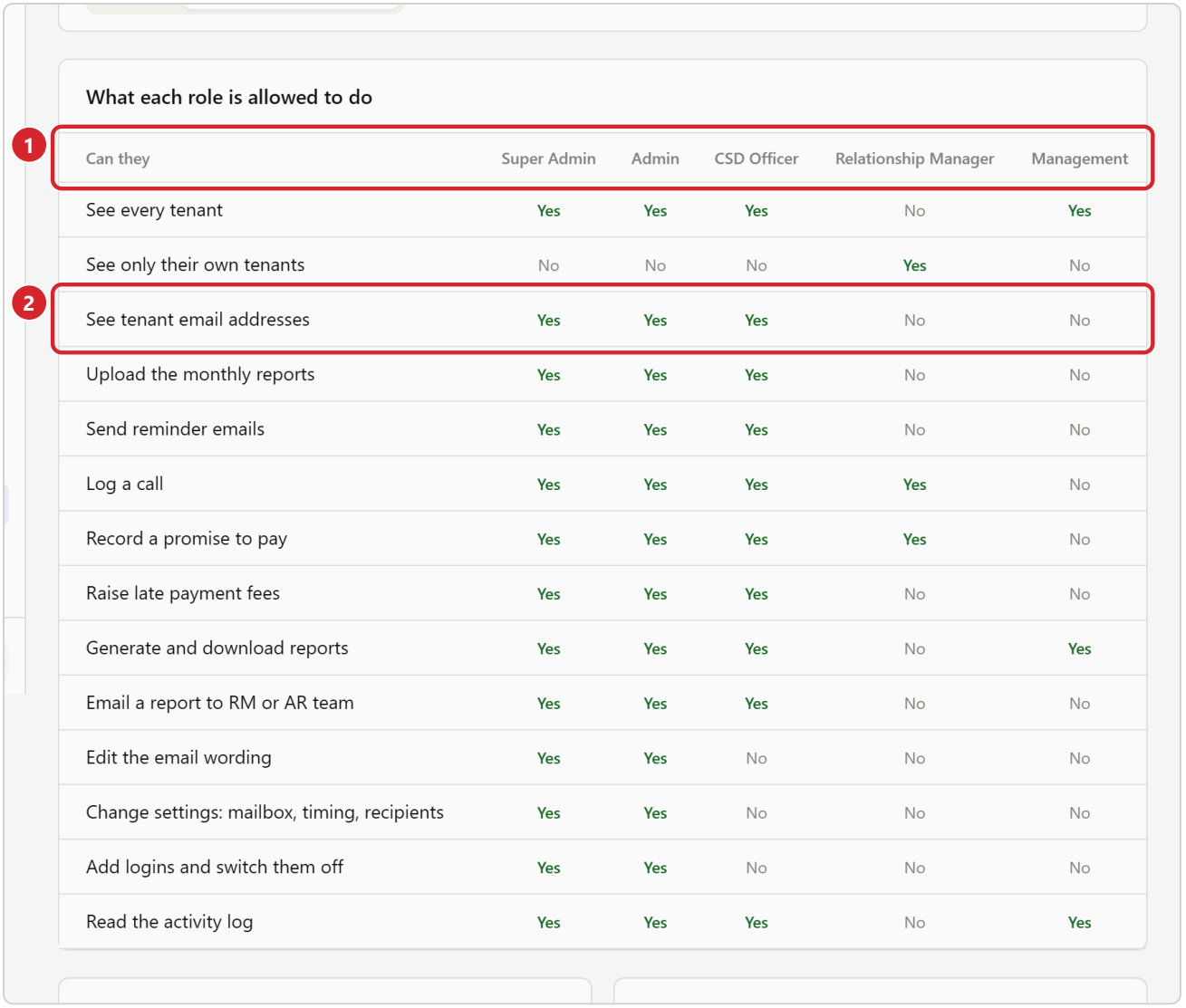
2.3 The roles

There are five roles. An administrator gives each person one when creating their login (chapter 10).

Role	What they do	Menu they see
Super Admin	Everything, including managing other administrators.	Everything
Admin	The full monthly cycle: upload, send, call, raise fees, export. Changes settings and manages logins, but not a Super Admin's.	Everything

CSD Officer	The daily collections work: upload, send, call, record promises, raise fees, reports. Cannot change settings or manage logins.	Everything except Settings and User Management
Relationship Manager	Only the tenants assigned to them. They can log a call and record a promise, and nothing else. They never see tenant email addresses.	Outstanding Balances and Call List, showing their own tenants only
Management	Totals and reports across every property. Read only.	Outstanding Balances, Reports and Export, Activity Log

The full list of what each role can do is on User Management, under the tab "What each role can do".



What each role is allowed to do

Can they	Super Admin	Admin	CSD Officer	Relationship Manager	Management
See every tenant	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
See only their own tenants	No	No	No	Yes	No
See tenant email addresses	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Upload the monthly reports	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Send reminder emails	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Log a call	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Record a promise to pay	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Raise late payment fees	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Generate and download reports	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Email a report to RM or AR team	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No
Edit the email wording	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Change settings: mailbox, timing, recipients	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Add logins and switch them off	Yes	Yes	No	No	No
Read the activity log	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes

Figure 2.3 What each role is allowed to do. A tick means the role can.

1. One column per role.
2. For example, a Relationship Manager cannot see tenant email addresses.

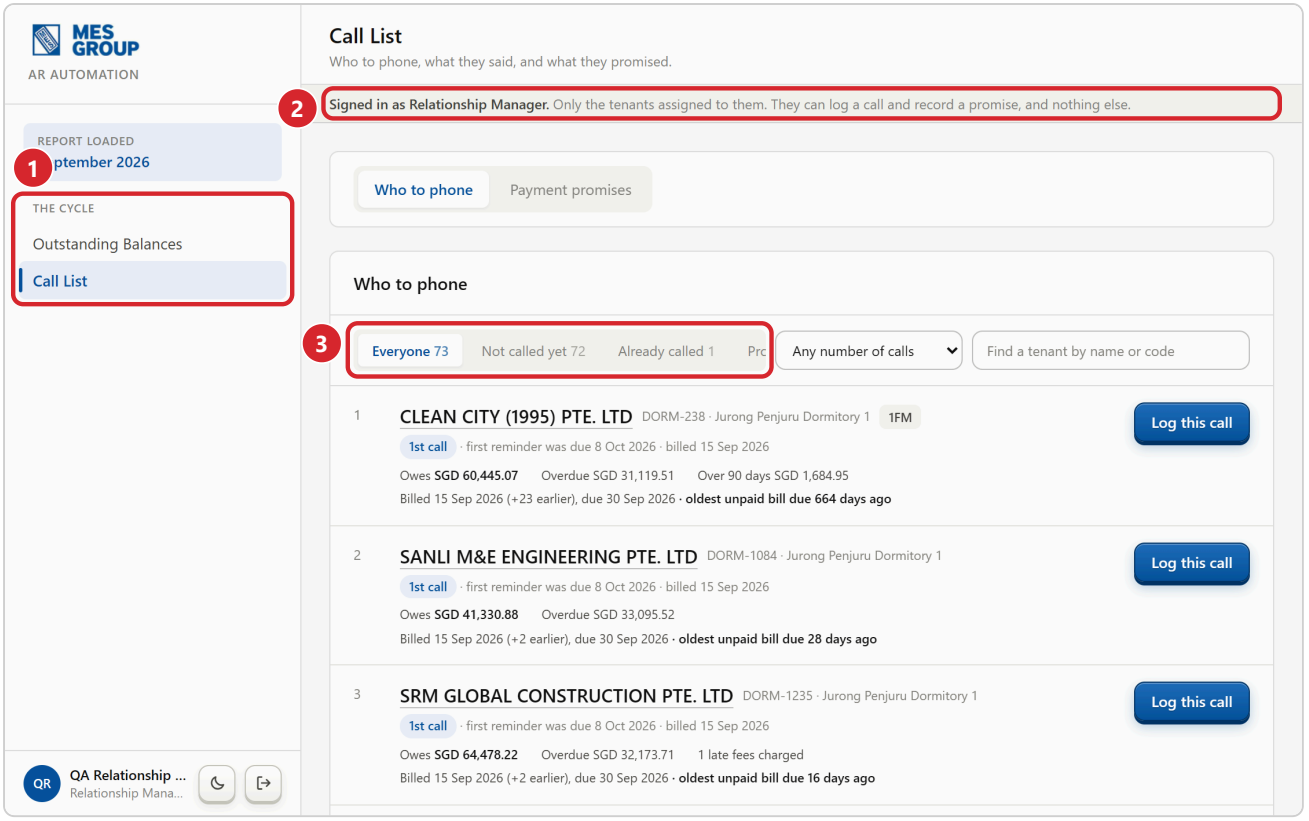


Figure 2.4 The Call List as a Relationship Manager sees it.

1. Only Outstanding Balances and Call List in the menu.
2. A line at the top of every screen says which role you are signed in as, and what it allows.
3. Only the tenants this manager looks after, so the counts are smaller.

GOOD TO KNOW

The roles are enforced by the system itself, not only by hiding menu items. A Relationship Manager who types the address of another screen is refused, and the system checks every tenant they ask for is one of their own.

2.4 Using it on a phone

Every screen works on a phone. The menu folds away behind the button at the top left, and tables become lists you scroll down.

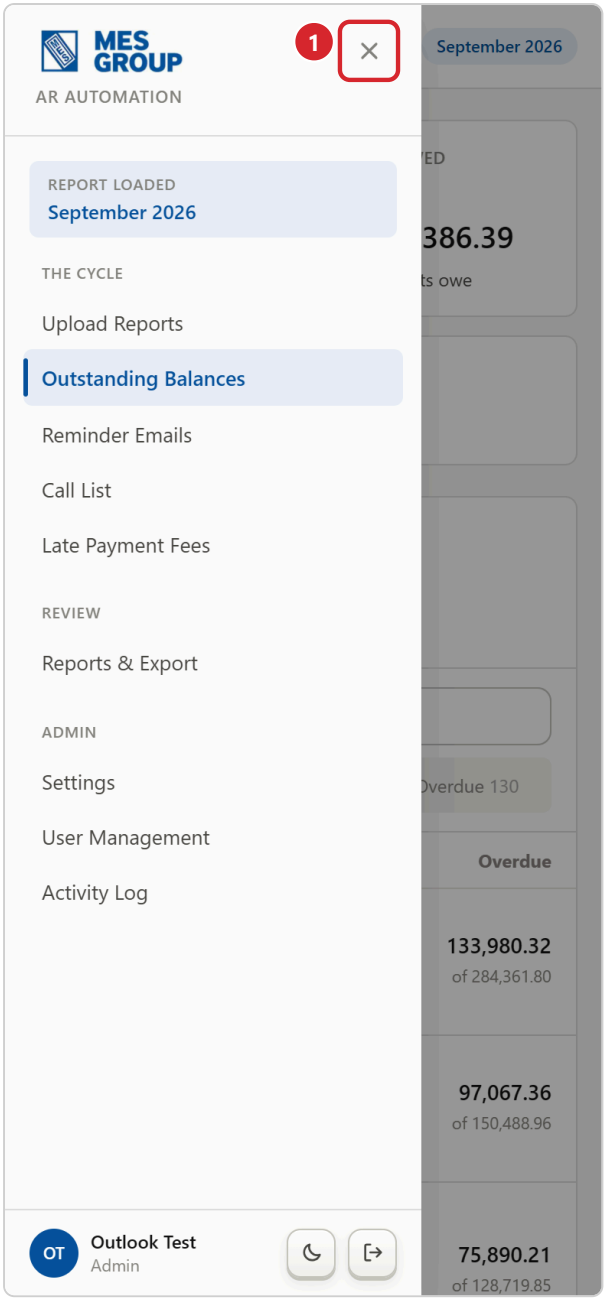


Figure 2.5 On a phone, with the menu open.

1. The same menu as on a computer. Press a screen to go to it, or press the cross to close the menu.

3 Upload Reports

Everything the system knows about who owes what comes from the AR report you upload here. Upload a new one after each billing run and whenever payments have been posted in NetSuite. Every screen, and the next 9am run, then works from it.

3.1 The two files

File	Where it comes from	How often
AR report required	NetSuite, Finance AR Download, from the Detailed AR report. The Custom A/R Aging Detail export also works. Save it as Excel and do not change it.	After each billing run, and when payments are posted. At least once a month.
Client contact list optional	MES's contact workbook. It needs a column headed Email Address next to the company names. Excel or CSV.	Only when addresses change. The last one uploaded is kept.

3.2 The screen

Open Upload Reports, the first item in the menu. The top of the screen shows which report every screen is using now. Below it are the three things to fill in.

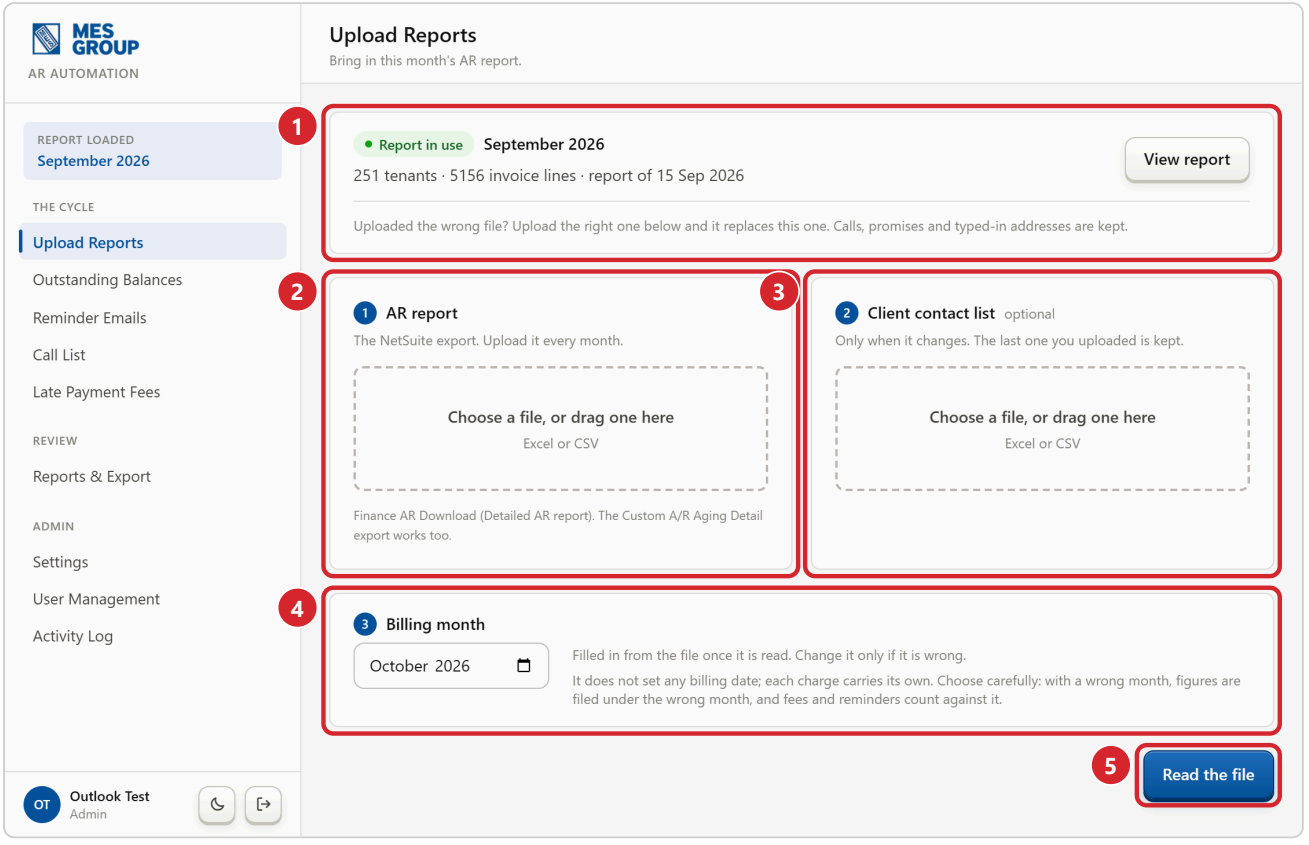


Figure 3.1 Upload Reports, before a file is chosen.

1. **Report in use.** The report every screen is reading now: its month, how many tenants and invoice lines it has, and its date. **View report** opens it.
2. **AR report.** Click the box, or drag the NetSuite file onto it.
3. **Client contact list**, if the addresses have changed. Leave it empty otherwise.
4. **Billing month.** Filled in from the file once it is read. Change it only if it is wrong.
5. **Read the file** checks the files. Nothing is saved yet.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
>
> Choosing the wrong file does no harm until you press **Use this report**. Even after that, you can upload the right file and it replaces the wrong one. Calls, promises and addresses typed in by hand are always kept.

3.3 Reading the file

1. Click the AR report box and choose the file exported from NetSuite. Its name appears in the box. To change your mind, press **Remove file**.
2. If the addresses have changed, choose the contact list in the second box.
3. Press **Read the file**. A large report takes a few seconds.
4. Check the billing month. The system suggests the month most tenants were last billed in, and says why, for example "7 of 15 tenants were last billed in October 2026".

> **CAREFUL**
>
> The billing month is a label for the month the report belongs to. It does not change any billing date, because every charge carries its own. A wrong month files the figures under the wrong month, and fees and reminders are counted against it.

3.4 Checking what was found

The system lists what it read from the file and anything worth a second look. Read the checks before saving.

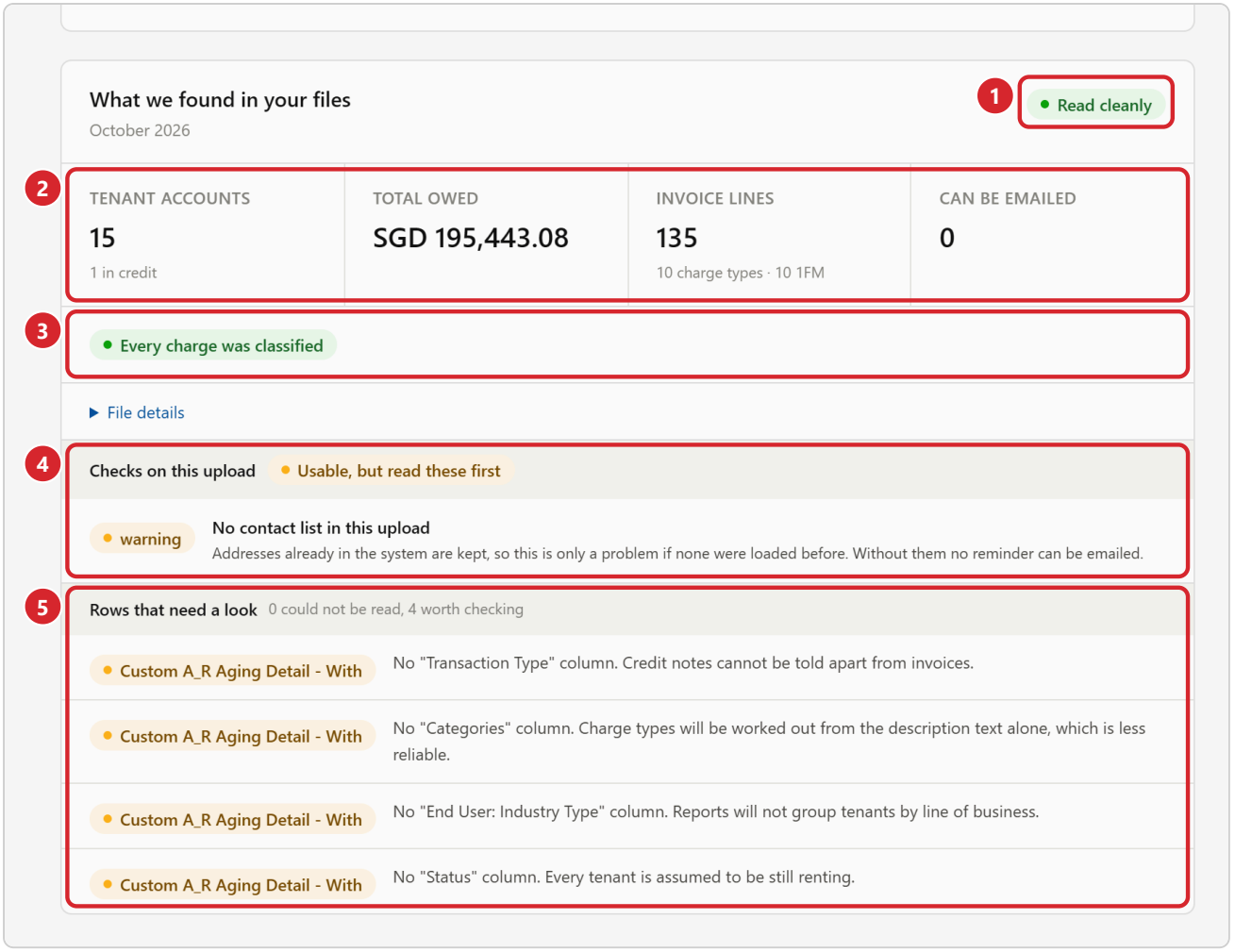


Figure 3.2 What was found in the file, and the checks on it. The figures come from a shortened test file.

1. **Whether the file could be read.** "Read cleanly" means every line was understood.
2. **The totals**: tenant accounts and how many are in credit, total owed, invoice lines and charge types, and how many tenants have an email address.
3. **Charge types.** Every charge description is sorted into a type. Any description the rules do not recognise is listed here by name.
4. **Checks on this upload.** The verdict is "Nothing of concern", "Usable, but read these first" or "Do not use this data". Each warning says what it means for you.
5. **Rows that need a look.** Lines that could not be read, and lines worth checking, each with the reason.

The warnings you are most likely to see:

Warning	What it means
No contact list in this upload	Not a problem if addresses were loaded before, because they are kept. Without any, no reminder can be emailed and every tenant goes to the By hand list.
No "Transaction Type" column	The export is missing a column, so credit notes cannot be told apart from invoices. Export again from the Detailed AR report.
No "Categories" column	Charge types are worked out from the description alone, which is less reliable.

No "Status" column	Every tenant is treated as still renting.
A file could not be read at all	It is not an AR report or a contact list. Nothing from it is used, and there is no Use this report button.

3.5 Comparing with the report in use

Before you save, the system compares the new file with the report every screen is using. This is the quickest way to spot the wrong file.

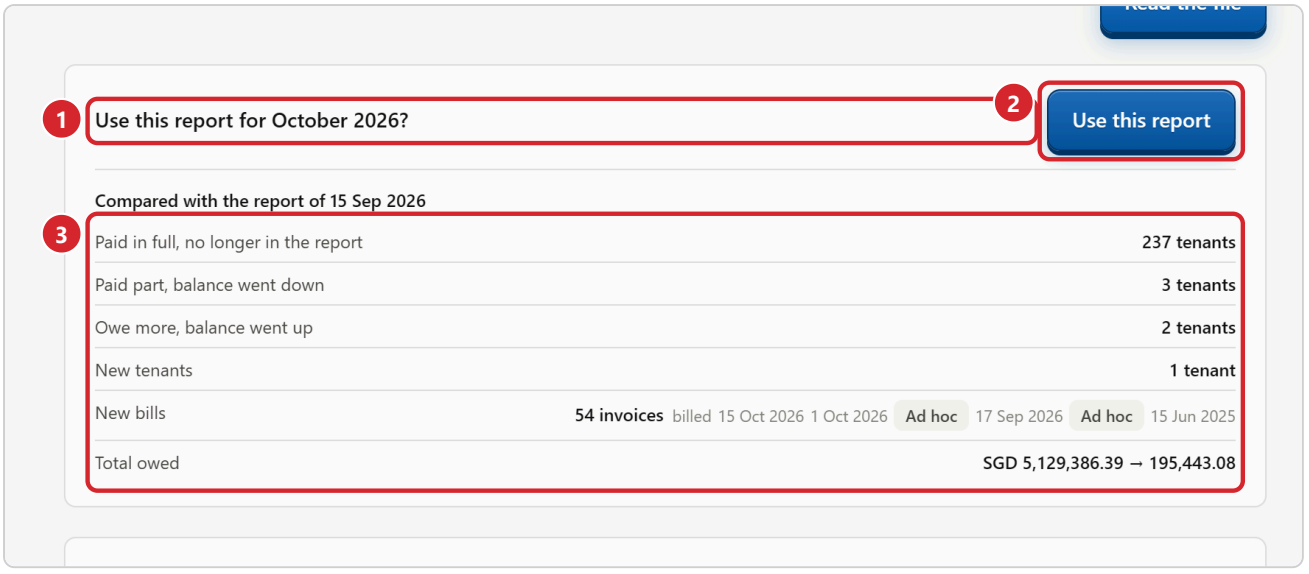


Figure 3.3 The question before saving, and what would change. The test file is much shorter than the report in use, which is why so many tenants show as paid.

1. **The question**: use this report for the month shown?
2. **Use this report** saves it for everyone. Nothing is saved until you press it.
3. **What would change.** Each line opens to list the tenants or invoices in it.

Line	Means
Paid in full, no longer in the report	The tenant was in the old report and is not in the new one. The system treats them as paid, so no more letters or calls.
Paid part, balance went down	Still owing, but less.
Owe more, balance went up	New charges since the last report.
New tenants	In the new report only.
New bills	Invoices not in the old report, grouped by billing date. Dates other than the 15th are marked Ad hoc.
Total owed	The old total, then the new one.

IF THE COMPARISON LOOKS WRONG

If almost every tenant shows as paid in full, or the new report is older than the one in use, you have probably chosen the wrong file or a partial export, and the screen warns you. Do not press Use this report. Choose the right file and read it again.

3.6 Saving

Press **Use this report**. The screen confirms "Saved. Everyone signed in now sees this report." The Report in use box changes to the new report, and the upload is recorded in the Activity Log as "Uploaded a report", with your name.

If you leave the screen before saving, the file and the comparison are kept until you come back, as long as you do not refresh the browser.

3.7 What happens in the background

- **Billing dates start the clocks.** Each invoice line's Date is its billing date. The lines are grouped by tenant and billing date. Each group gets its own first reminder 23 days later and its own final notice 37 days later, and the next 9am run picks them up.
- **Due dates come from the report.** If a group's lines carry one due date, that date is used. If not, the due date is 14 days after billing. The late fee counts from the due date.
- **Tenants who have gone have paid.** They drop off Reminder Emails, the Call List and the fee list, and their promises to pay are marked "Paid, no longer owing".
- **Charges are sorted by type** from their description, using the rules under Settings, Charge types. A tenant with a Rejected GIRO Fee line is treated as paying by GIRO and is not charged the late fee.
- **Addresses are matched by company name.** A contact list adds or updates addresses. Addresses typed in by hand are kept.
- **A corrected export replaces, it does not add.** Saving a report with the same report date as an earlier one replaces that day's figures.
- **The report's age is watched.** If no newer report has been saved for more than 16 days, the 9am run still runs and the Activity Log shows a warning.

4 Outstanding Balances

Outstanding Balances is the first screen after signing in. It lists every tenant in the report in use, with what they owe and how late it is, most overdue first. Use it to answer "how much is outstanding and who owes it", and to open any tenant's own page.

4.1 The screen

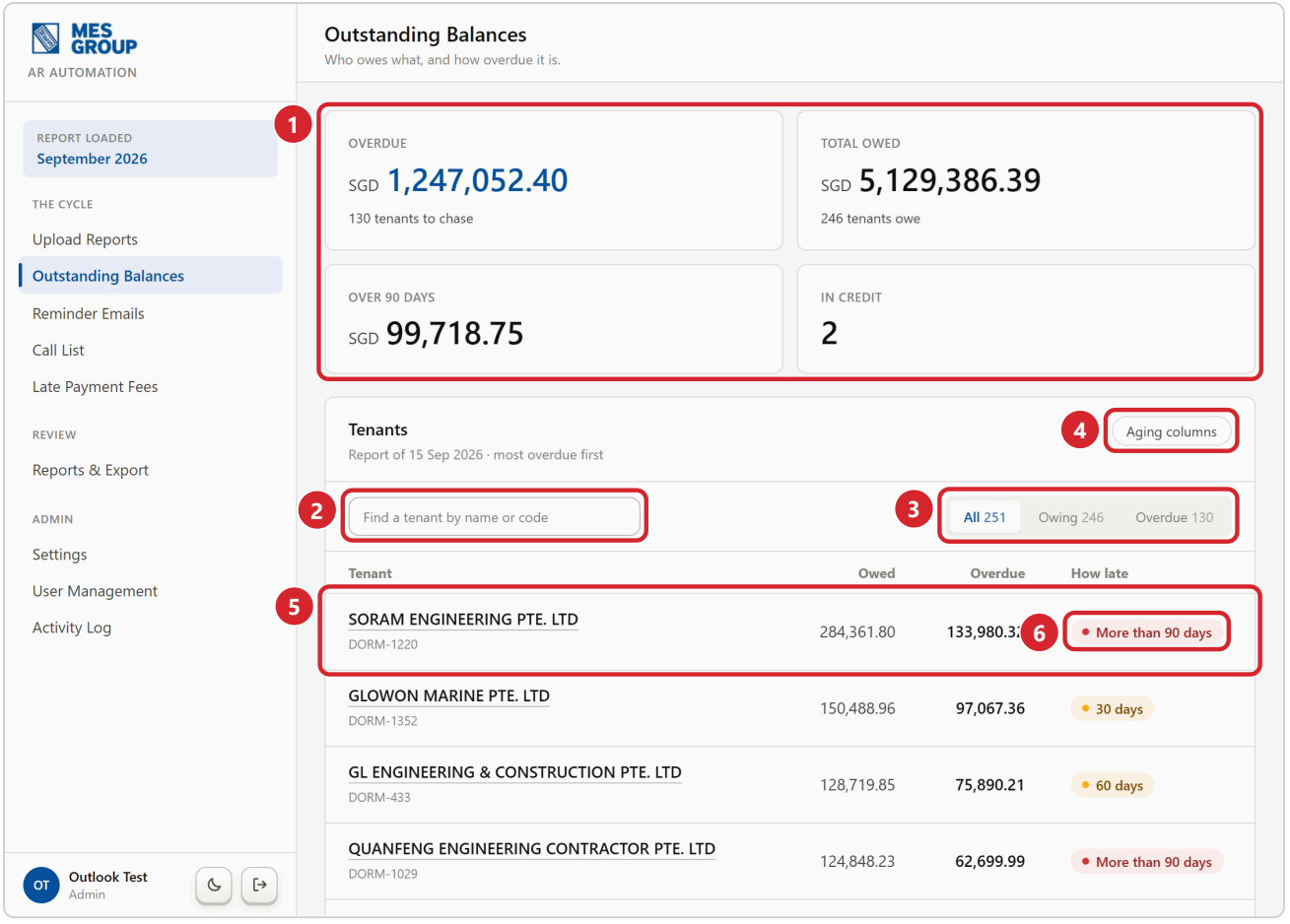


Figure 4.1 Outstanding Balances.

1. **The four totals.** Overdue is money 30 days old or more, with how many tenants that is. Total owed is everything in the report. Over 90 days is the hardest money to recover. In credit counts tenants who have paid more than they owe.
2. Find a tenant by name or account code.
3. **All**, only those who **Owe**, or only those who are **Overdue**.
4. **Aging columns** splits each tenant's money by age (section 4.2).
5. One tenant: name, account code, what they owe in total and how much of it is overdue. Click the name to open their page.
6. **How late** their oldest unpaid money is.

The list shows 25 tenants at a time. Use Previous and Next at the bottom to move through it.

4.2 Money by age

Press **Aging columns** to see each tenant's money split into Current, 30 days, 60 days, 90 days and More than 90 days. Click any column heading to sort by it, and click again to reverse the order. Everything to the right of the thicker line, 30 days and older, needs chasing.

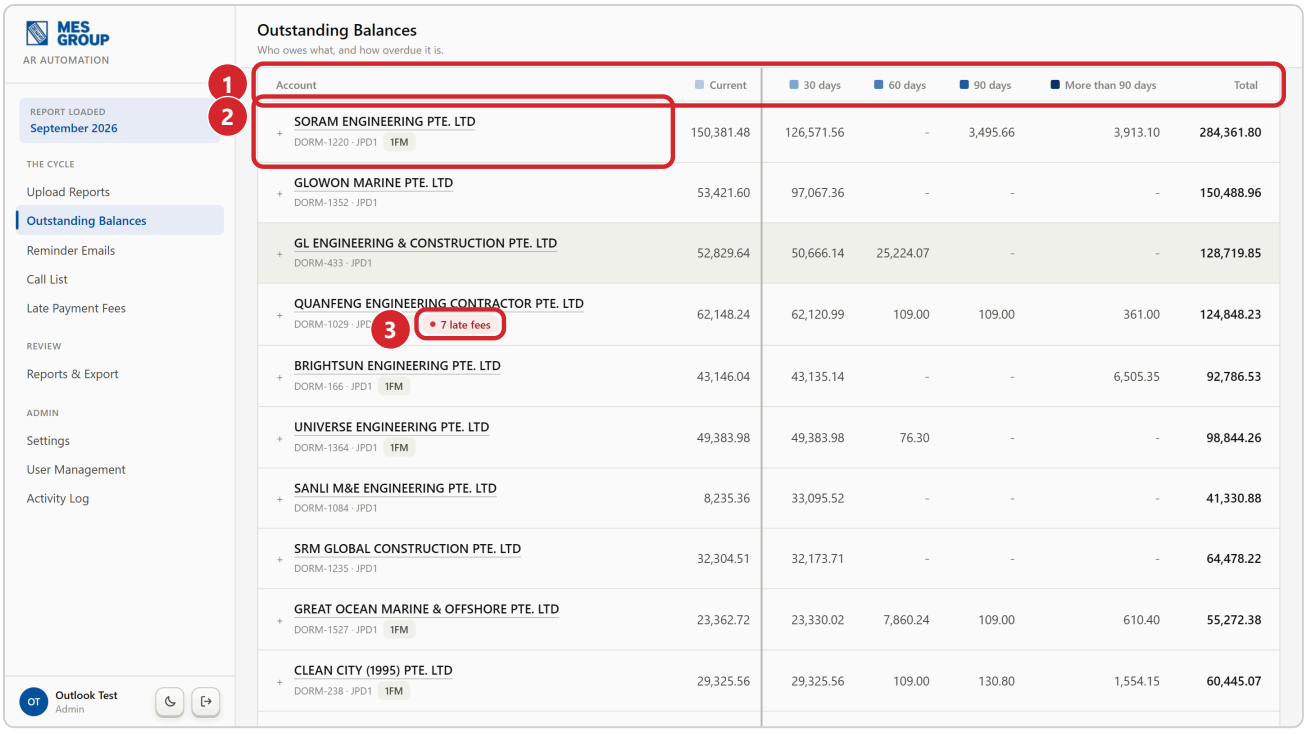


Figure 4.2 The same list with the aging columns showing.

1. The age columns, as in MES's own aging report. Click a heading to sort.
2. Press + at the start of a row to see that tenant's invoice lines without leaving the list.
3. Marks on a row: 1FM for 1FM Maintenance tenants, and the number of late fees charged when there have been three or more.

4.3 Adding an email address

A tenant with no email address cannot be sent reminders. In the aging columns view their row shows **No email, add one**.

1. Press **No email, add one** on the tenant's row.
2. Type the address. For more than one, separate them with commas.
3. Press Enter. The notice "Email saved" confirms it, and the tenant gets their reminders from now on.

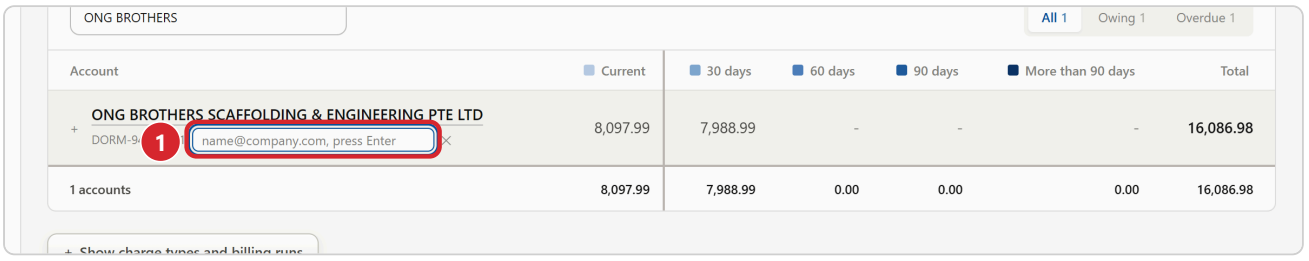


Figure 4.3 Typing in an address for a tenant who has none.

1 Type the address and press Enter to save it. Press the cross to cancel.

To add many addresses at once, use the contact list on Upload Reports instead. An address typed in here is kept when a new contact list or report is uploaded.

4.4 Charge types and billing runs

At the bottom of the screen, **Show charge types and billing runs** opens two more tables.

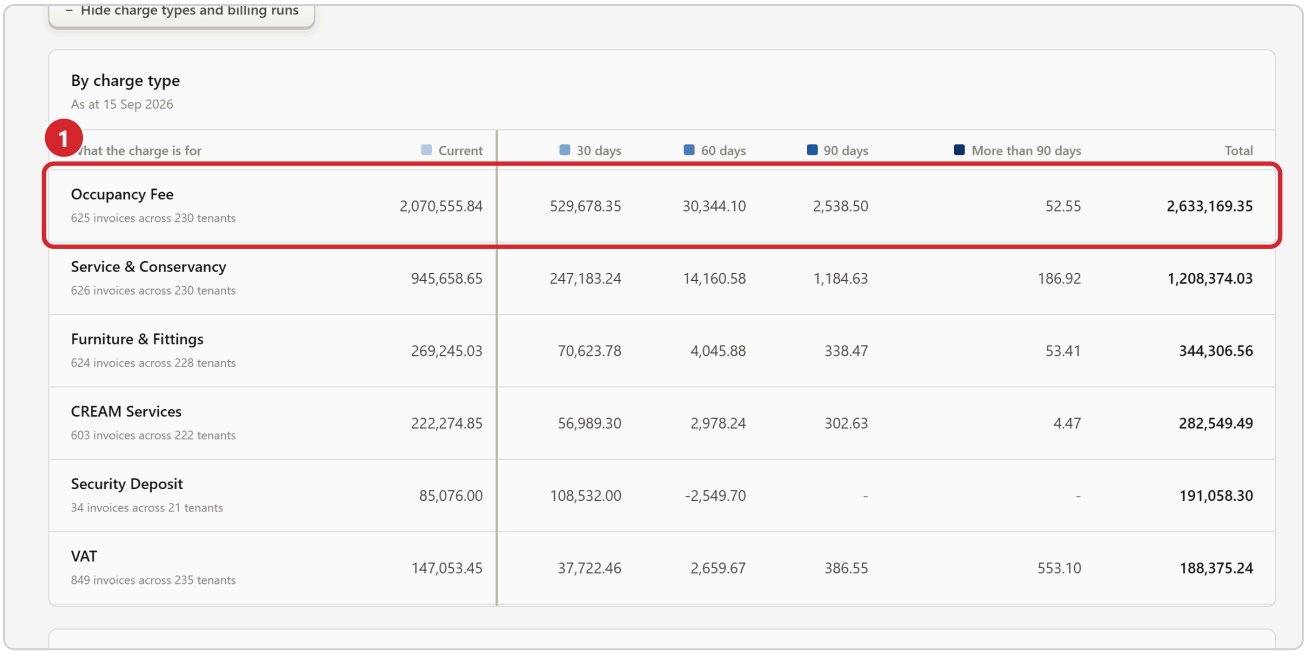


Figure 4.4 What is owed, by charge type. The total at the foot of the table matches Total owed at the top of the screen.

1 One charge type, with how many invoices and tenants it covers, and the money in it by age.

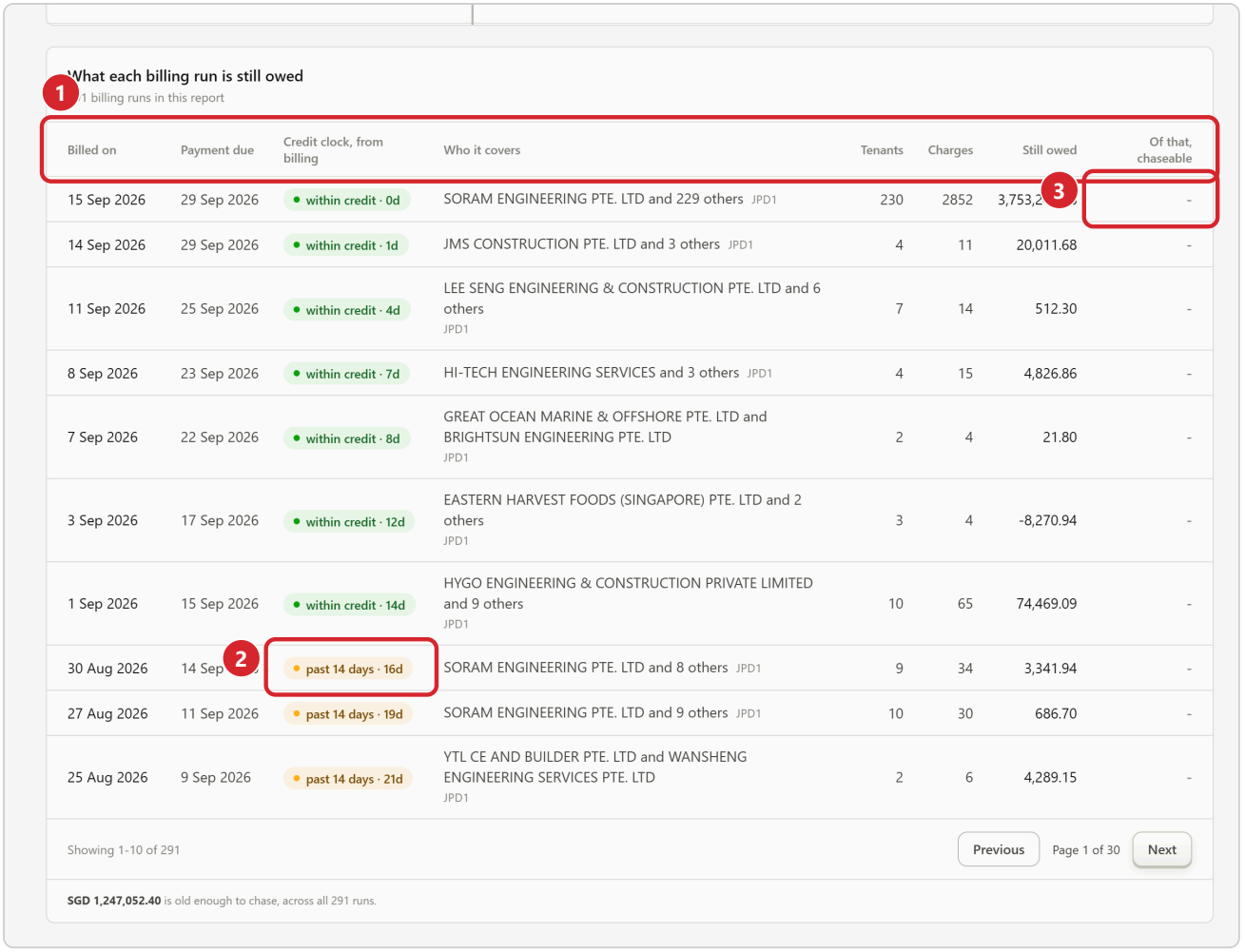


Figure 4.5 What each billing run is still owed, newest first.

1. One row per billing date: when it was billed, when payment was due, how long since billing, who it covers, and what is still owed.
2. The credit clock, counted from the billing date: within credit, past 14 days, or past 30 days.
3. Of that, chaseable: the part more than 15 days past its due date, which is where MES's aging stops calling a charge Current.

4.5 One tenant's page

Click a tenant's name anywhere in the system to open their page. It shows everything about that tenant in one place.

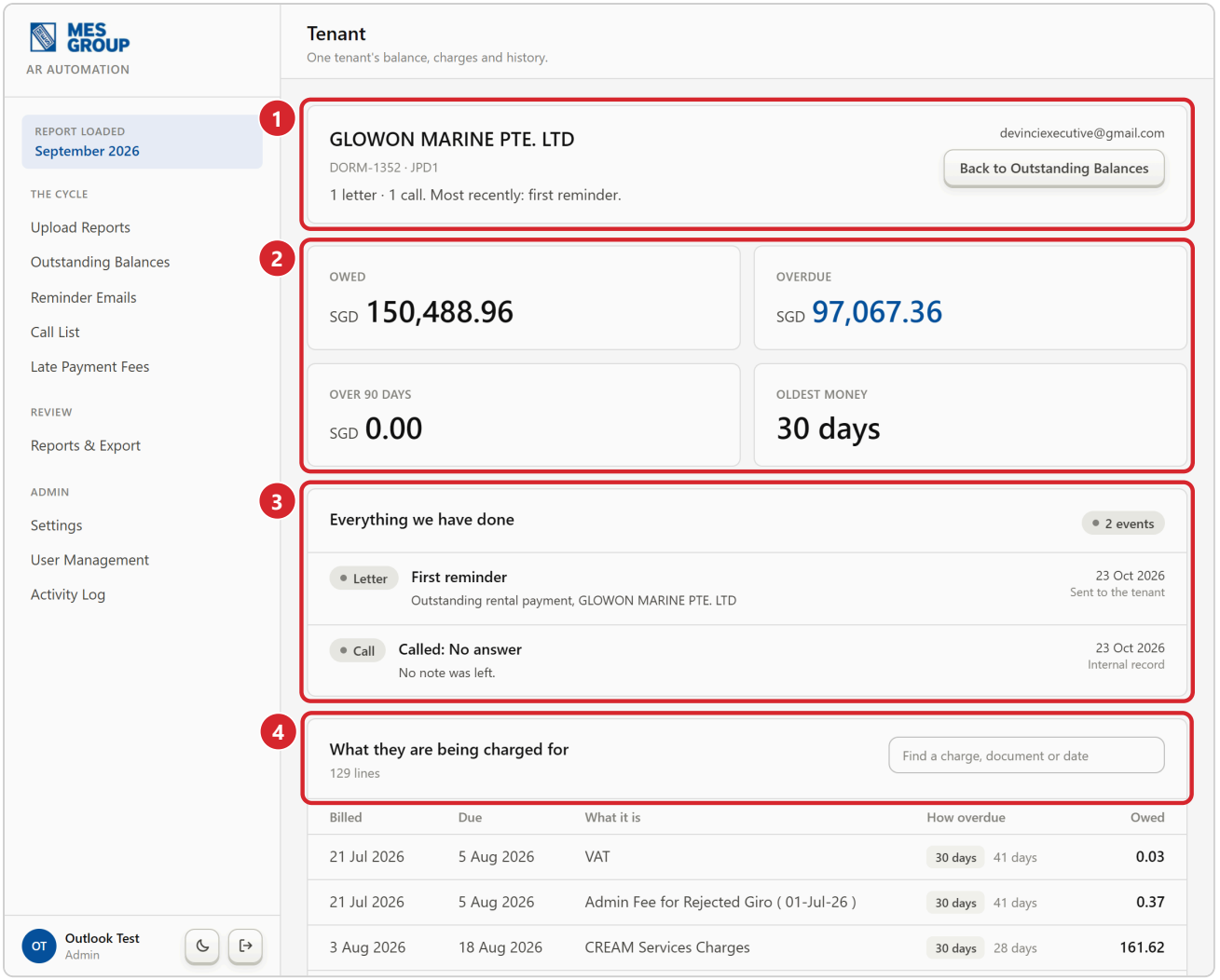


Figure 4.6 A tenant's page.

1. The tenant, their account code and dormitory, their email address, and how many letters and calls there have been.
2. What they owe, how much is overdue, how much is over 90 days old, and the age of their oldest money.
3. Everything done for this tenant, newest first: letters, calls, promises and fees. Each says whether it reached the tenant or is an internal record.
4. Every charge line from the report, with its billing date, due date, what it is and how overdue it is. Search by charge, document or date.

Back to Outstanding Balances at the top returns you to the screen you came from.

4.6 What happens in the background

- **Every figure comes from the report in use.** The date under Tenants, "Report of 15 Sep 2026" for example, is that report's own date, not today's.
- **Overdue follows MES's aging.** Money is overdue once it reaches the 30 days column. Current covers anything up to 15 days past its due date.
- **A tenant in credit is never chased.** They get no letters and no late fee.
- **A Relationship Manager sees only their own tenants** on this screen, and the totals at the top are for those tenants only.

5 Reminder Emails

Reminder Emails is where the letters live: the ones due today, every letter that has gone, where each tenant's bills stand, and the tenants who can only be written to by hand. The 9am run sends the letters on its own, so most days you come here to check, not to send.

5.1 The screen

The screen has five tabs. The number beside a tab is how many letters are in it.

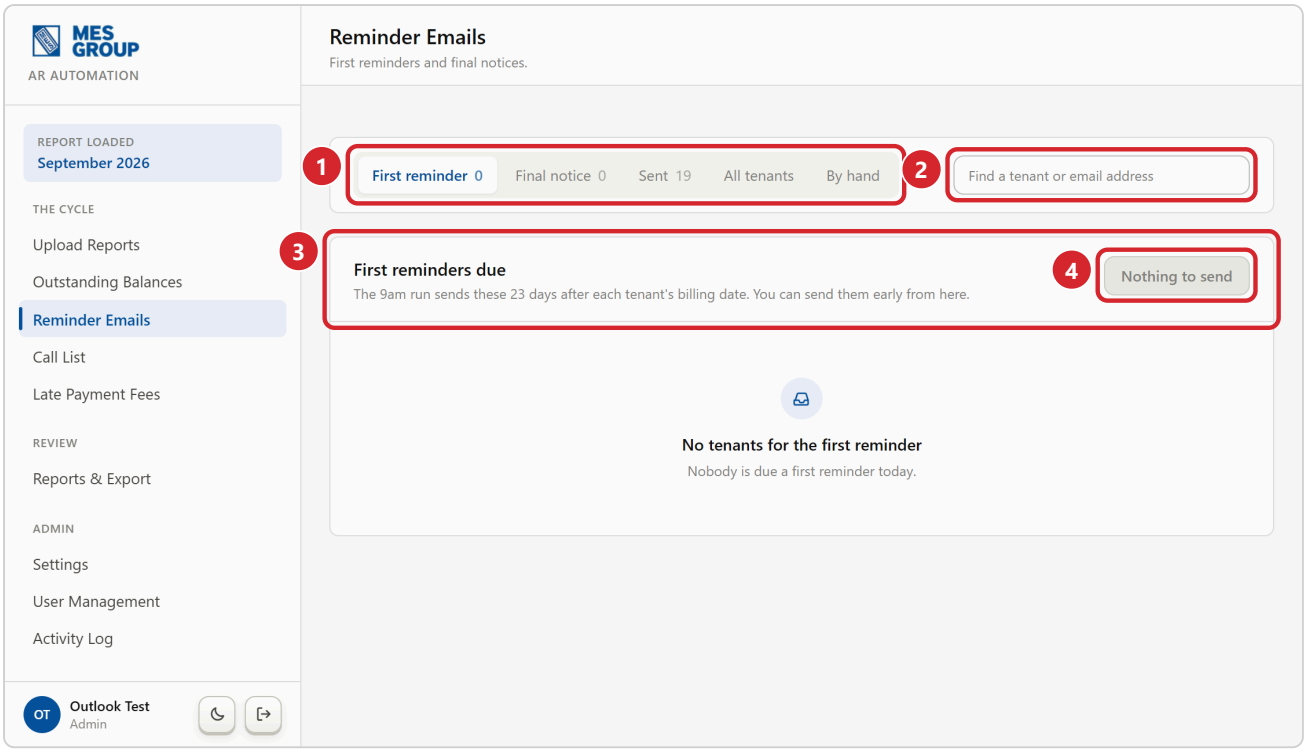


Figure 5.1 Reminder Emails, on the First reminder tab.

1. **First reminder** and **Final notice**: the letters due today that have not gone yet. **Sent**: every letter that has gone. **All tenants**: when each bill is chased. **By hand**: tenants with no email address.
2. Find a tenant by name or email address.
3. How many days after billing this letter goes, as set in Settings.
4. **Send all** sends every letter in the list. When the list is empty it reads "Nothing to send".

5.2 The letters due today

The First reminder and Final notice tabs list the same letters the 9am run sends today. On a normal day the run has sent them by the time you look, and both lists are empty, as in figure 5.1. A letter stays on the list when it could not go, for example because no mailbox was connected. You can then send it from here.

Each row shows the tenant, the addresses the letter goes to, and the amount it asks for, which is the total of the bills on that billing date. Each row has two buttons.

- **Read and send** opens the letter as the tenant will get it. You can change the subject or the wording for this one letter, then press **Send this email**.
- **Edit letter** changes what the 9am run sends to this tenant for this bill (section 5.4).

To send the whole list at once, press **Send all**. A window lists every tenant, the addresses and the amount asked for. Press **Send all** again in that window to send them. They go in small batches with a short pause between, the same pace as the 9am run, and the button counts them as they go. If any are refused, the window stays open so you can see which.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
>
> Sending a letter yourself counts the same as the 9am run sending it. The run will not send the same letter again for that bill.

5.3 Where each tenant stands

The All tenants tab shows every tenant's bills, one row per tenant per billing date, with the day each letter falls due and what has happened so far.

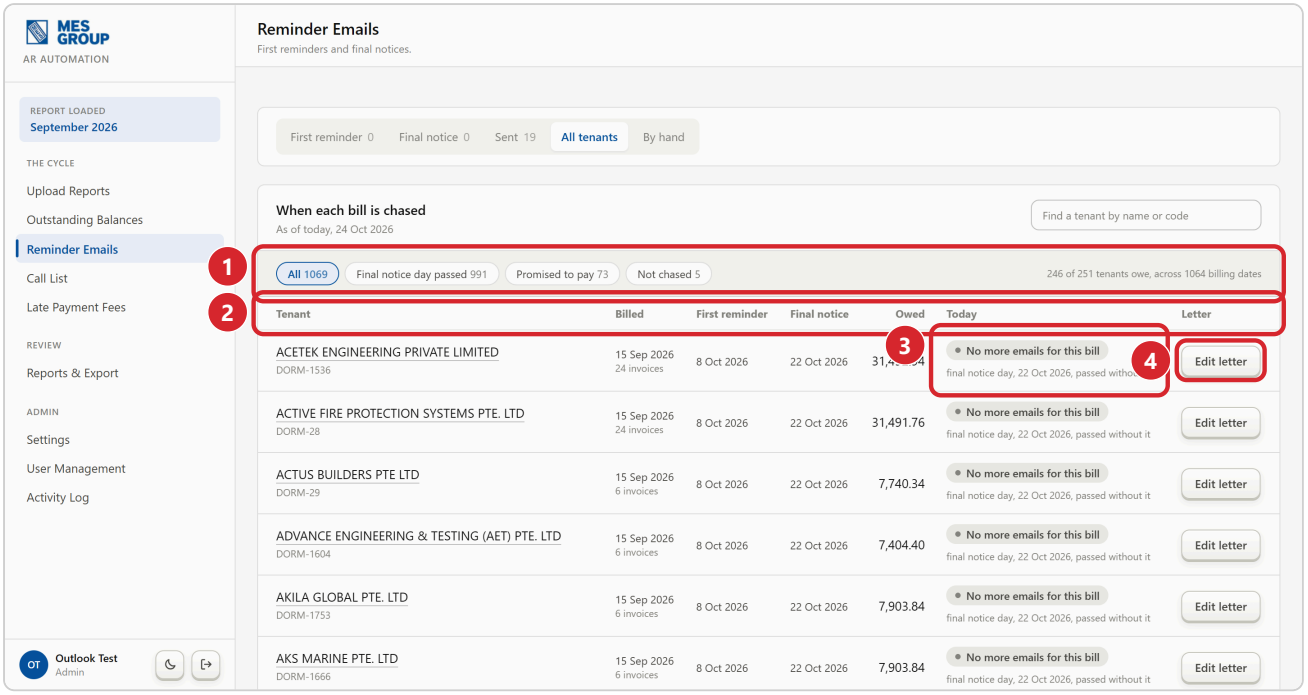


Figure 5.2 All tenants: when each bill is chased.

1. **Where they stand.** Click one to show only those bills, for example Final notice day passed or Promised to pay.
2. For each bill: the tenant, when it was billed and how many invoices it has, the day of the first reminder and of the final notice, and what is owed.
3. **Today**: what has happened to this bill and what happens next.
4. **Edit letter** for this tenant and this bill.

What the Today column can say:

It says	Meaning

Not yet due	The first reminder day has not come.
First reminder due, Final notice due	The letter goes today.
First reminder sent, with a date	Waiting for the final notice day.
Final notice sent, with a date	Both letters have gone. The tenant is on the Call List for a second call.
First reminder day passed	The day went by without a letter. The final notice still goes on its day, unless Settings says otherwise.
No more emails for this bill	The final notice day has passed too. Chase this bill by phone.
Promised to pay by, with a date	Letters are held until that date.
In credit, or Nothing owed	Not chased.
No billing date	The report gave this bill no date, so it cannot be timed. Check the report.

5.4 Editing one tenant's letter

Sometimes one tenant needs different wording, for example when an arrangement has been agreed. Edit letter changes what the 9am run sends to that tenant, for that bill only. Everyone else still gets MES's standard letter.

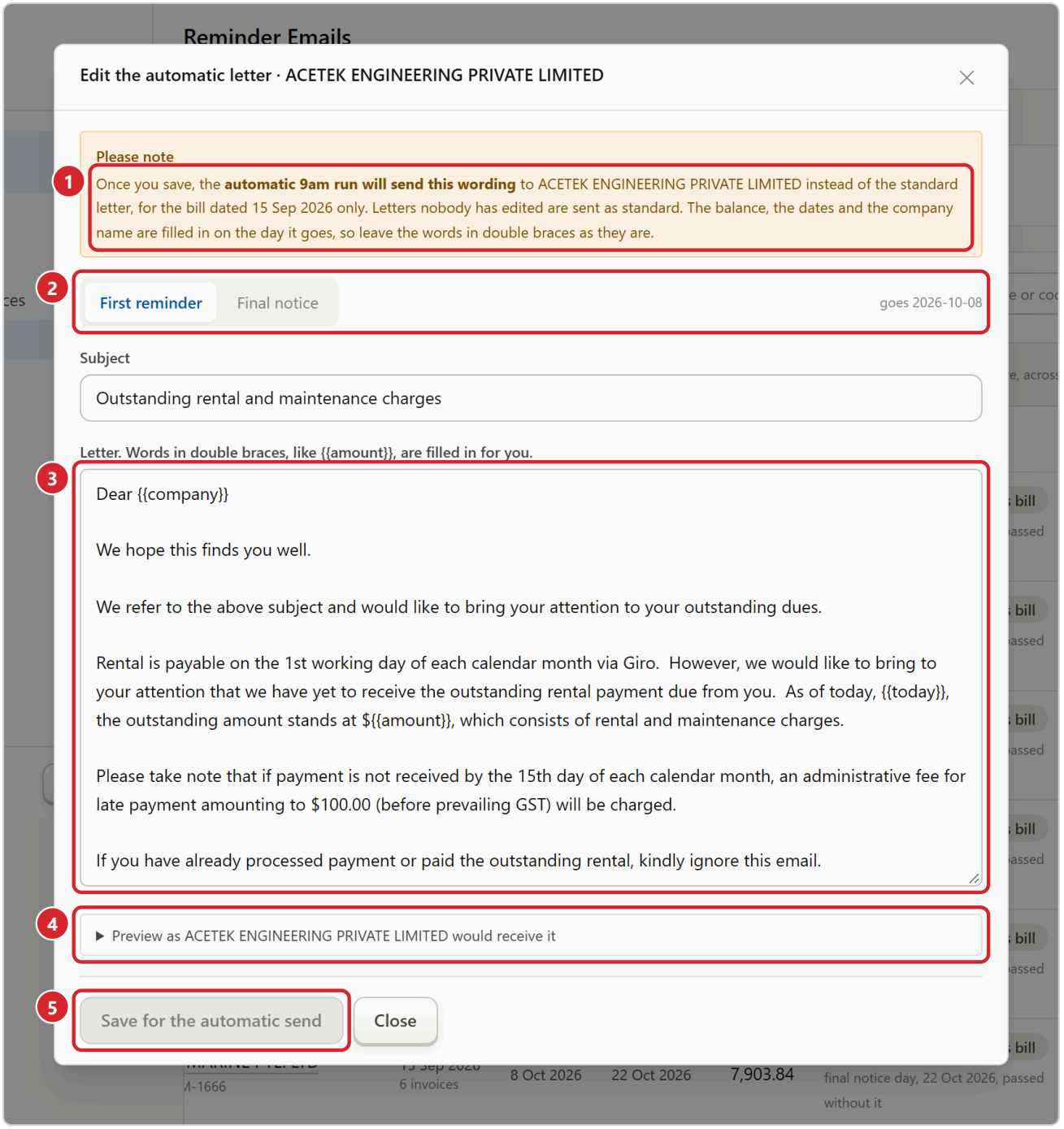


Figure 5.3 Editing the automatic letter for one tenant.

1. What saving does, said before anything else: the 9am run will send this wording to this tenant, for this bill only.
2. Which letter you are editing, the first reminder or the final notice, and the day it goes.
3. The wording. Leave the words in double braces, such as {{amount}}, as they are. They are filled in on the day the letter goes.
4. Open the preview to read the letter exactly as the tenant will get it.
5. **Save for the automatic send.** It stays greyed out until you change something.

1. Find the tenant on the All tenants tab, or on the First reminder or Final notice tab, and press **Edit letter**.
2. Choose the letter at the top: First reminder or Final notice.
3. Change the subject or the wording.
4. Open the preview and read it through.

5. Press **Save for the automatic send**. The tenant's row is then marked Edited.

To undo an edit, open the letter again and press **Back to the standard wording**.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> An edit changes what a tenant is told about money, and it goes out without anyone pressing send. Read the preview before saving. If a word in double braces is misspelt, the system refuses to save and lists the ones it fills in, so a tenant never receives a letter with {{amont}} where the amount should be.

5.5 The Sent tab

The Sent tab lists every letter the system has sent, newest first. This is the place to look when a tenant asks whether their reminder went out.

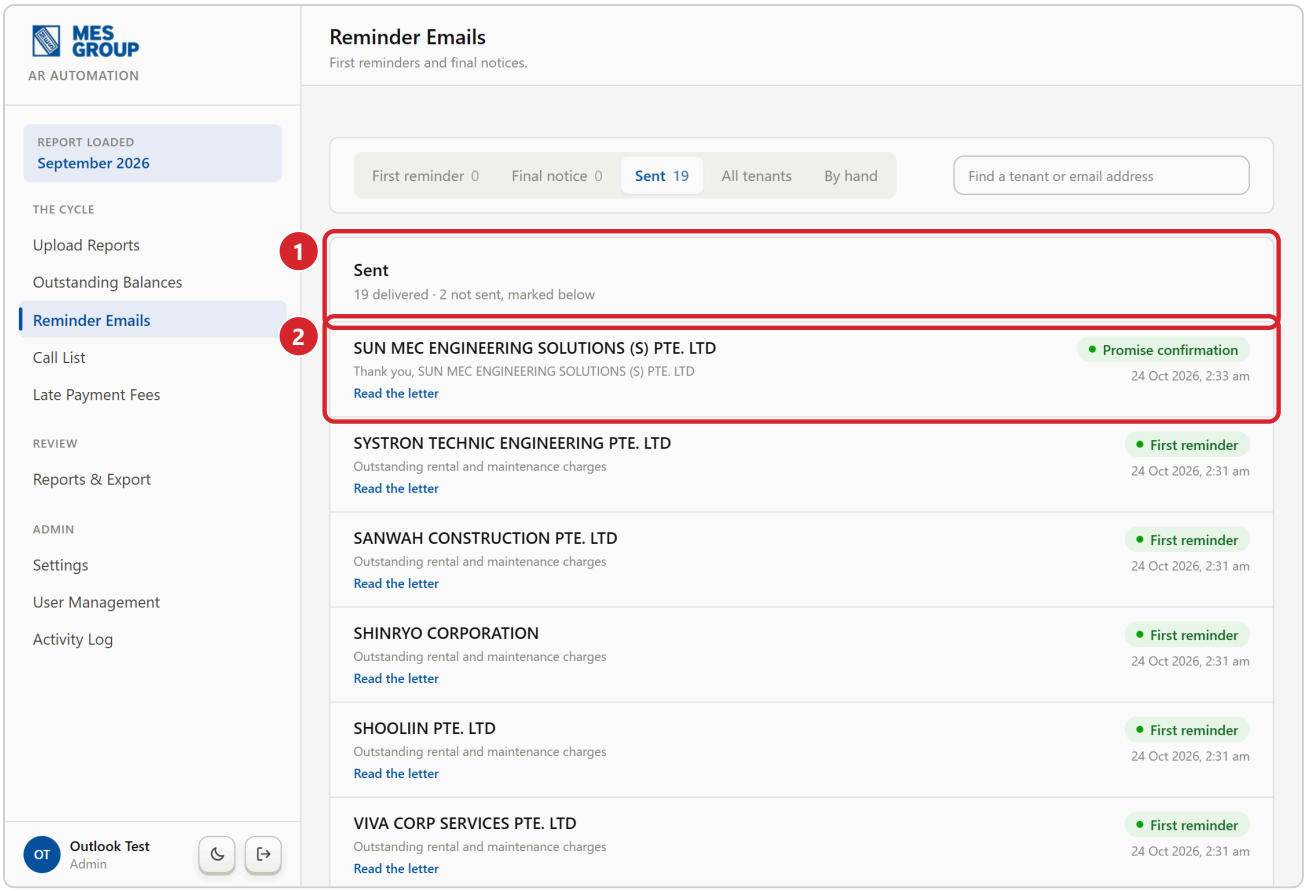


Figure 5.4 The Sent tab.

1. How many were delivered, and how many were written but not sent.
2. One letter: the tenant, the subject, which letter it was and when it went. Click it to read the letter.

A letter marked "not sent" in red was written but did not leave, usually because sending was off or the mailbox needed reconnecting. The Activity Log has the reason.

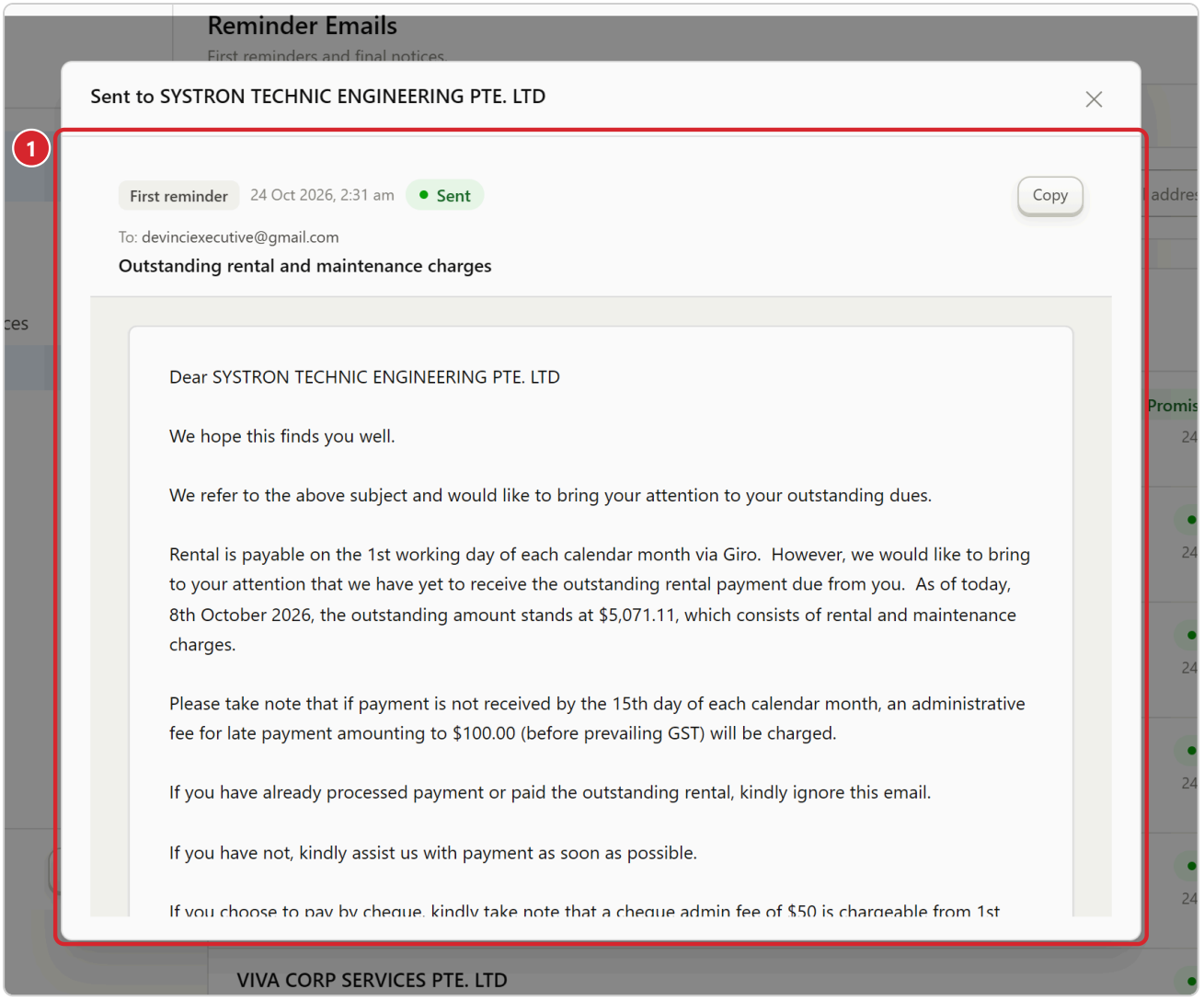


Figure 5.5 A sent letter, opened.

1 Who it went to, when, the subject and the letter exactly as it was sent.

5.6 Tenants with no email address

The By hand tab is for tenants the system cannot email. Their letters are written on the same day as everyone else's, and you post them yourself from Outlook.

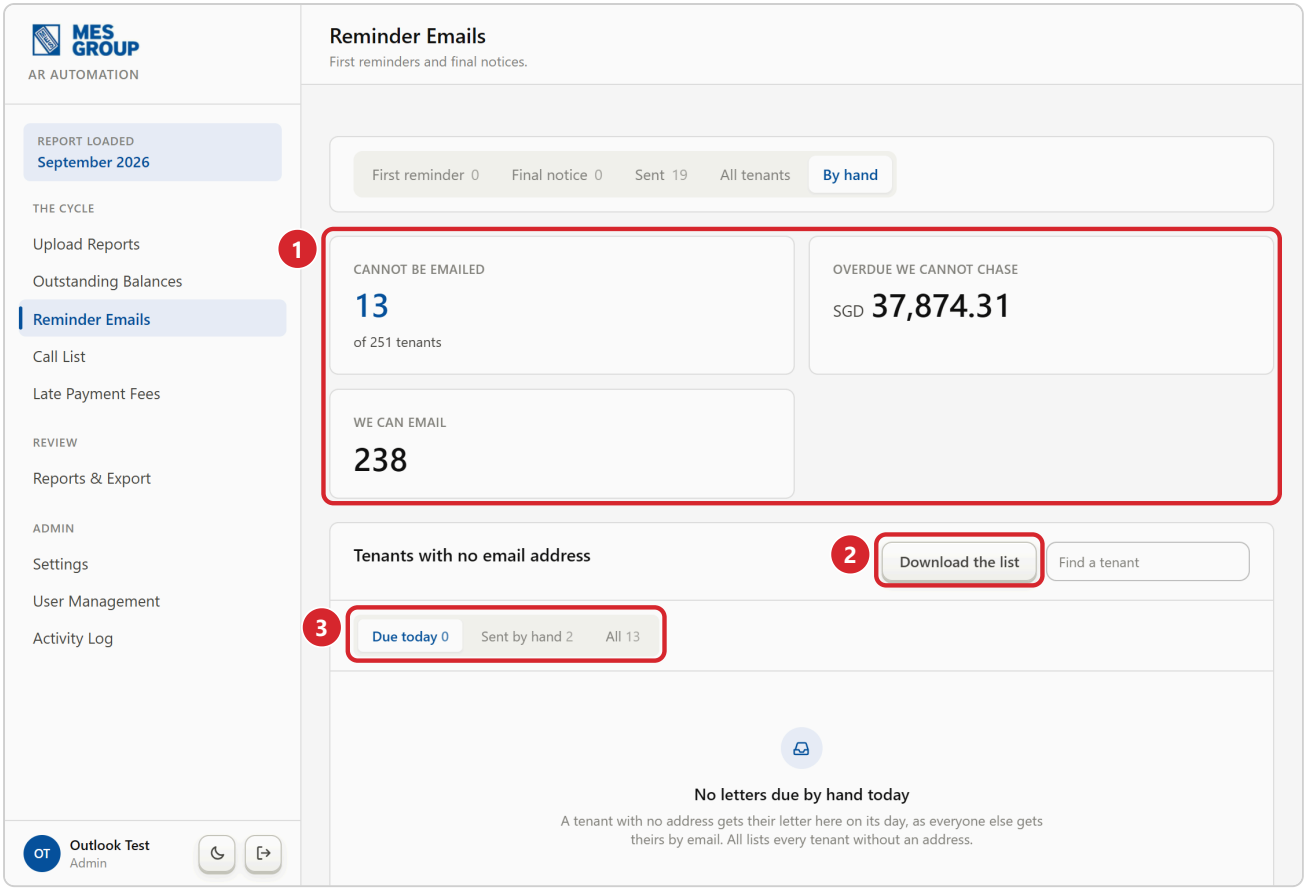


Figure 5.6 The By hand tab.

1. How many tenants have no address, the overdue money that cannot be chased by email, and how many tenants can be emailed.
2. **Download the list** of tenants with no address, as a spreadsheet.
3. **Due today**: letters to post today. **Sent by hand**: those marked as posted. **All**: every tenant with no address.

1. On Due today, open a tenant's letter.
2. Press **Copy** beside the subject and paste it into a new email in Outlook. Do the same for the letter.
3. Send it from Outlook to the address you have for them.
4. Back in the system, press **I have sent this by hand**. This records the letter against the tenant, so the system knows it went.

If you find their address, type it into the box at the bottom of the letter window. They then get their letters automatically like everyone else. To fill in many addresses at once, download the list, add the addresses in the Email Address column, and upload it as a contact list on Upload Reports.

5.7 What happens in the background

- **Who is due a letter today** is worked out exactly as the 9am run works it out: each bill that reaches 23 days old today gets a first reminder, and each that reaches 37 days gets a final notice.
- **Several bills, one email.** A tenant with several bills due the same letter on the same day gets one email asking for their combined total.

- **The amount in a letter** is that billing date's total, not the tenant's whole balance. The letter does not list the invoices.
- **The date in a letter** is the date of the report in use, and the deadline to pay is counted from it, so the letter never quotes a balance for a day it does not have.
- **Promises hold letters.** A tenant who has promised to pay by a date that has not passed is left out.
- **Sent means sent.** A letter counts as sent only once the mail server has accepted it. One that was refused is kept and marked "not sent", and stays on that day's list to be sent again.

6 Call List and payment promises

MES chases with a letter and then a phone call. The Call List says who to phone today and why, and records what came of each call. When a tenant agrees to pay, the promise is kept on the Payment promises tab until the date comes.

6.1 Who to phone

A tenant joins the list once their first reminder date has passed and they still owe. They are due a first call after the first reminder, and a second call after the final notice. Worst cases come first.

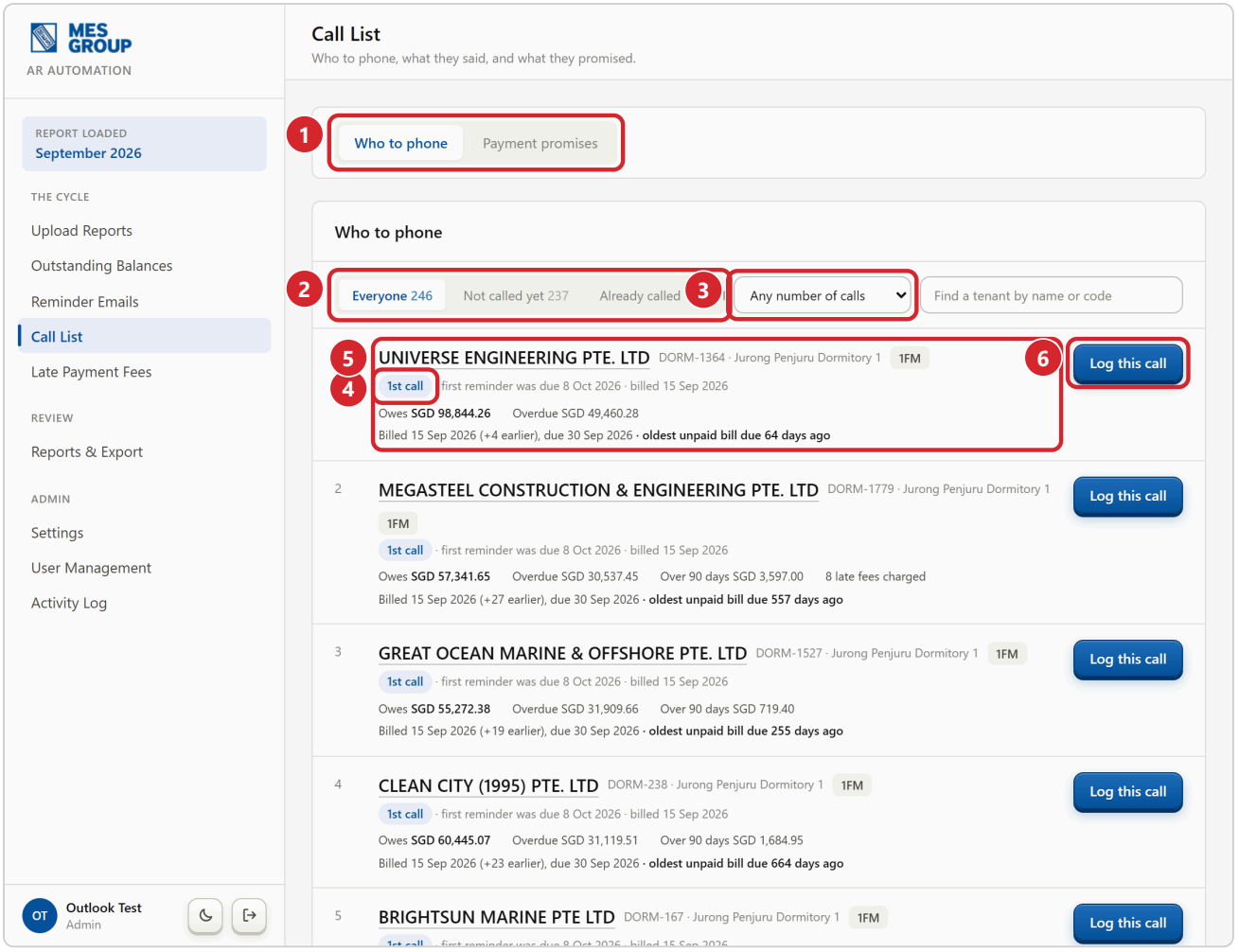


Figure 6.1 The Call List, on the Who to phone tab.

1. **Who to phone**, or **Payment promises** (section 6.5).
2. **Everyone**, **Not called yet**, **Already called**, or **Promised to pay**.
3. Narrow by how many times the tenant has been called, for example Never called.
4. Which call this is, and why: "1st call, first reminder was due 8 Oct 2026", with the billing date.
5. What they owe, how much is overdue and over 90 days, any late fees, and their oldest unpaid bill.
6. **Log this call** when you hang up.

A tenant billed on several dates is on the list once. The call is about everything they owe and follows their latest letter.

6.2 Logging a call

1. Phone the tenant. Their account details are at the top of the call window, so you do not need to look anything up.
2. Press **Log this call** on their row.
3. Check which reminder the call is about. It is filled in for you from the list.
4. Type who you spoke to, for example "Serene, accounts".
5. Choose what happened. Nothing is chosen for you.
6. If they agreed to pay, check the amount, which starts as what they have overdue, and type the date they said they would pay by. The date cannot be in the past.
7. Set a date to check back if you want a reminder to call again, and add any note worth keeping.
8. Press **Save this call**.

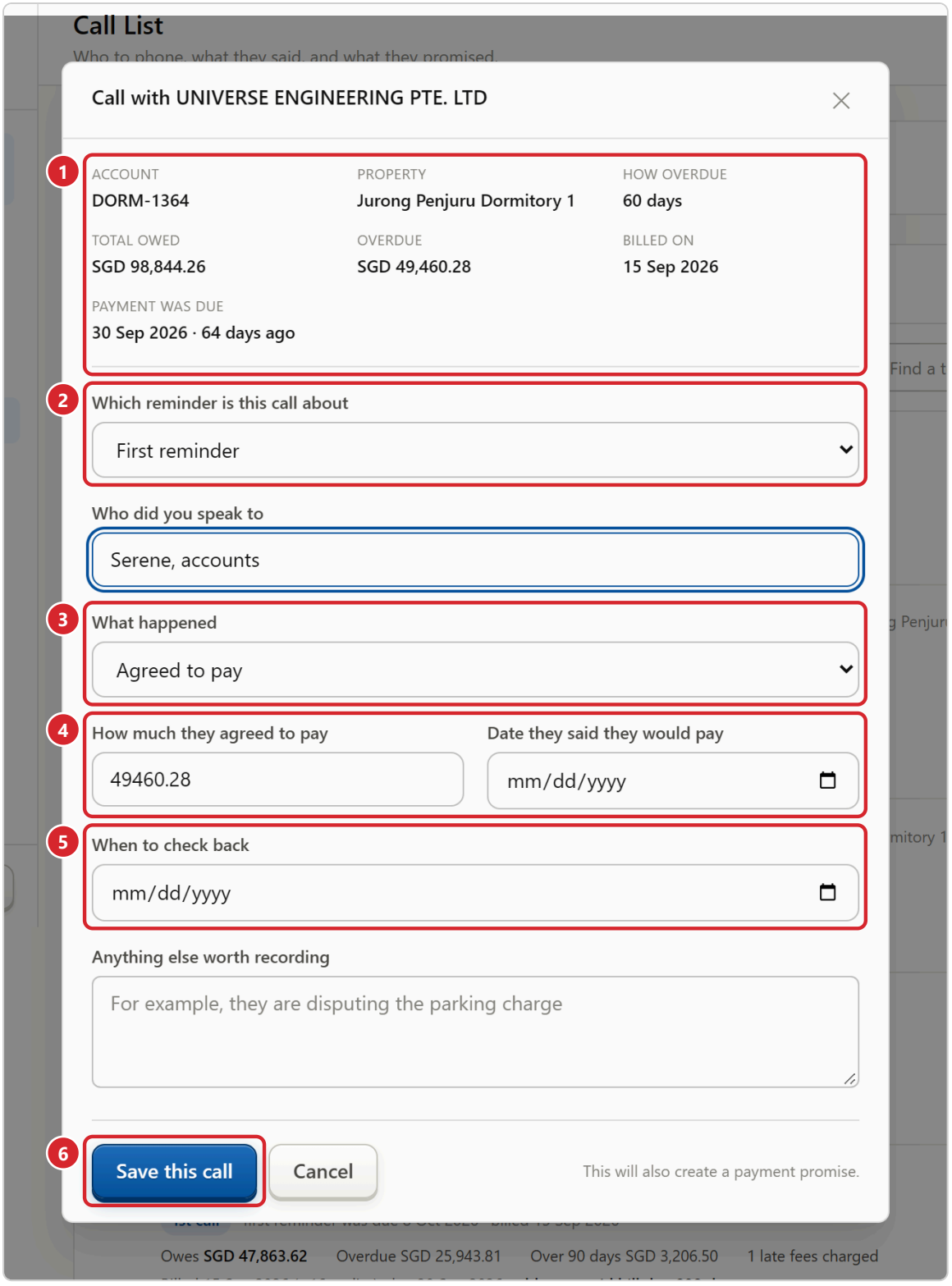


Figure 6.2 The call window, with Agreed to pay chosen.

1. The tenant's account, dormitory, how overdue they are, what they owe, and when their bill was raised and fell due.
2. Which reminder the call follows.
3. What happened: Agreed to pay, Said they would call back, Disagrees with the amount, Nobody answered, or Wrong number.
4. Only for Agreed to pay: how much, and by when. This becomes a payment promise.
5. A date to come back to this tenant.

6 **Save this call.**

The notice after saving says where the call went: "Recorded in the activity log and the NetSuite export", or, for a promise, "added to Payment Promises".

6.3 Calls already logged

Below the list of who to phone, the Calls logged box keeps every call, newest first.

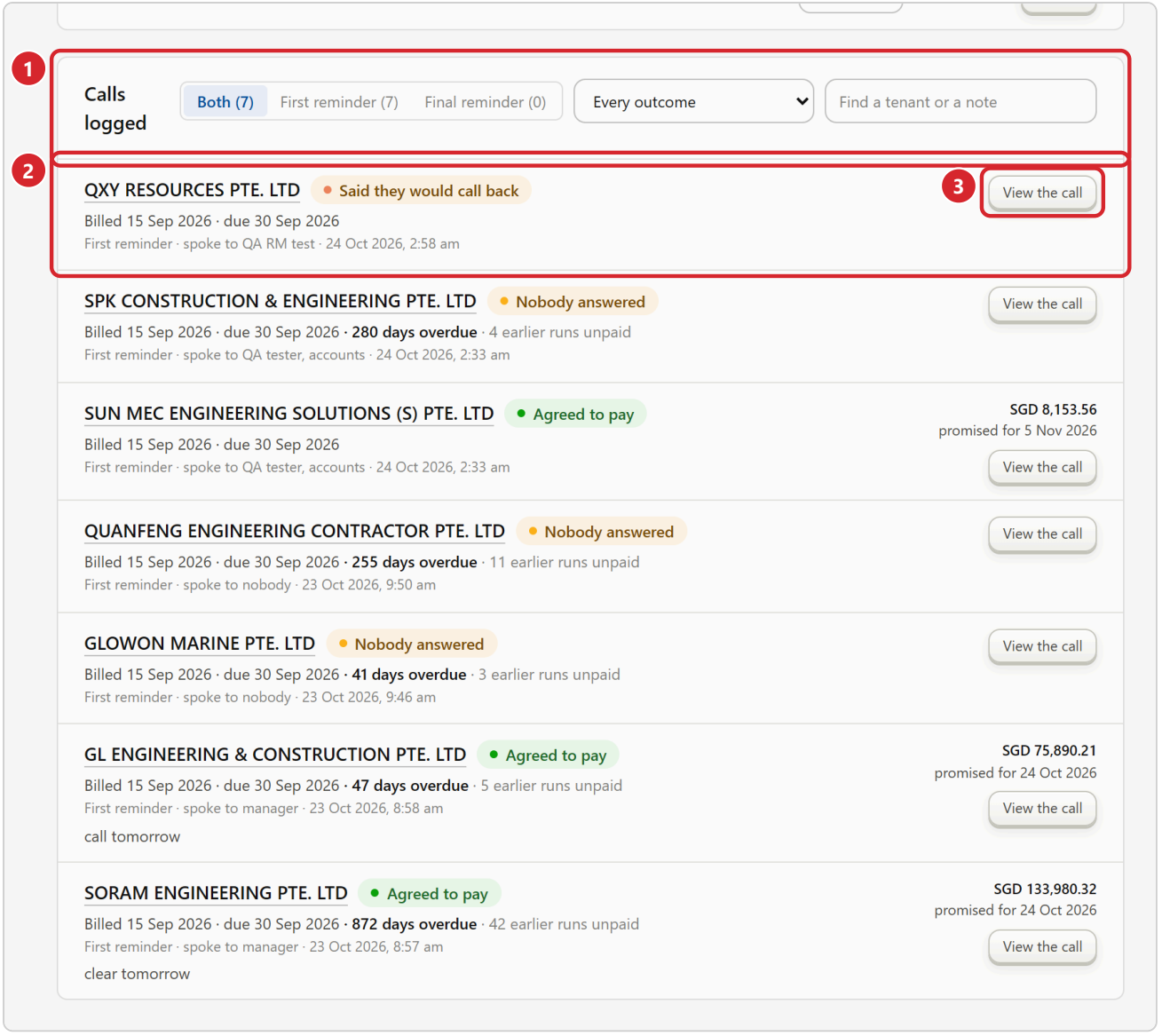


Figure 6.3 Calls logged.

1 Narrow by reminder or by what happened, or search for a tenant or a word in the notes.

2 One call: the tenant, what happened, their bill, who was spoken to and when, and any promise.

3 **View the call** opens the form as it was filled in.

6.4 Reading a logged call

View the call shows every answer from the call form, read only, including the date to check back, which is not shown in the list.

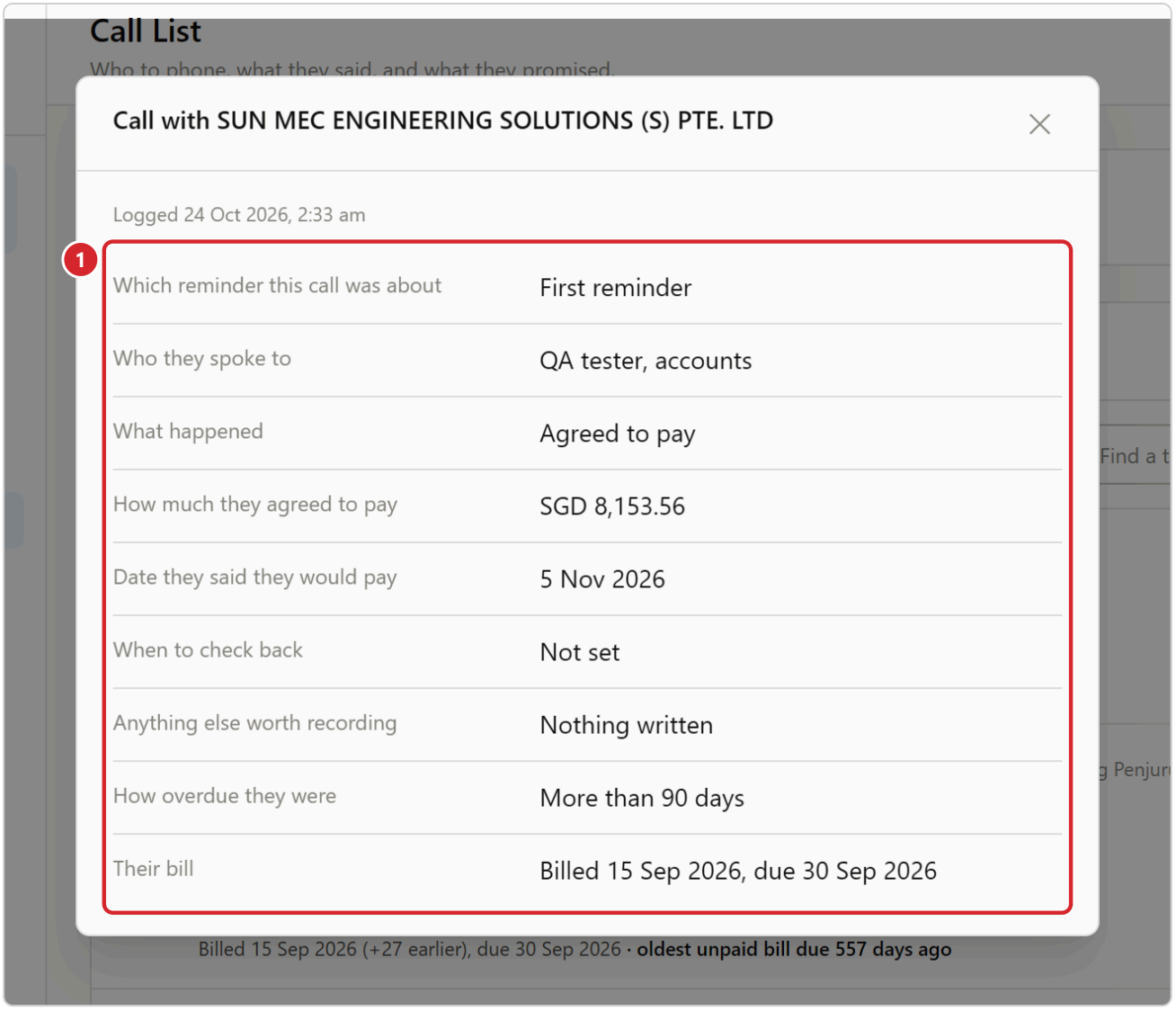


Figure 6.4 A logged call, opened.

1 Each question from the form and the answer given, with how overdue the tenant was and their bill at the time.

6.5 Payment promises

The Payment promises tab lists every promise to pay, whether it came from a call or from a tenant replying to a reminder.

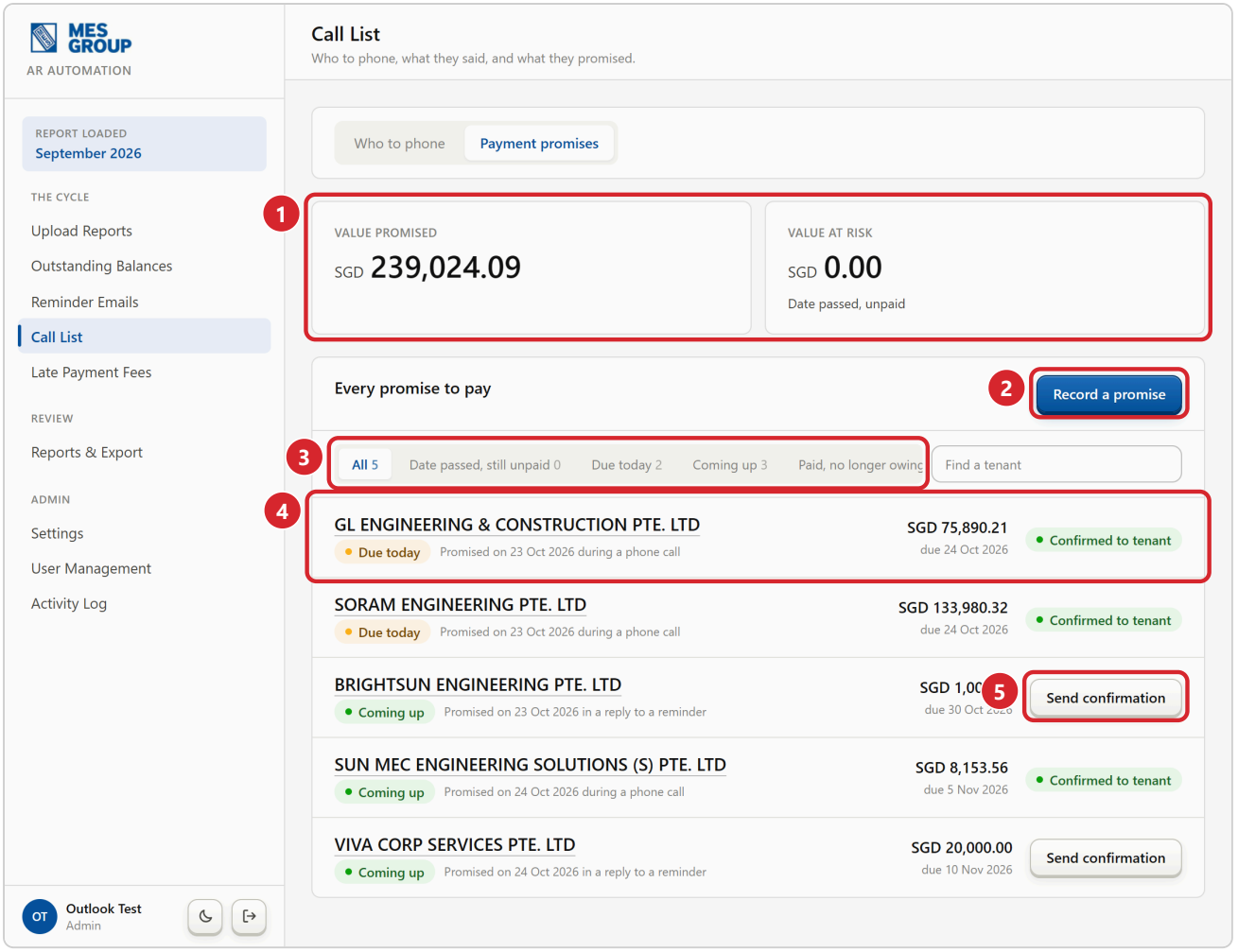


Figure 6.5 The Payment promises tab.

1. **Value promised**, the total of promises not yet paid. **Value at risk**, promises whose date has passed unpaid.
2. **Record a promise** that did not come from a call, for example a reply to a reminder.
3. Date passed, still unpaid. Due today. Coming up. Paid, no longer owing.
4. One promise: how much, by when, when it was made and how.
5. **Send confirmation** emails the tenant a short note of what they promised. Once sent it reads "Confirmed to tenant".

Recording a promise by hand

1. Press **Record a promise**.
2. Find the tenant by typing part of their name or code, and choose them.
3. Type the amount and the date they promised to pay by.
4. Choose where it came from: a reply to a reminder, or a phone call.
5. Press **Record it**.

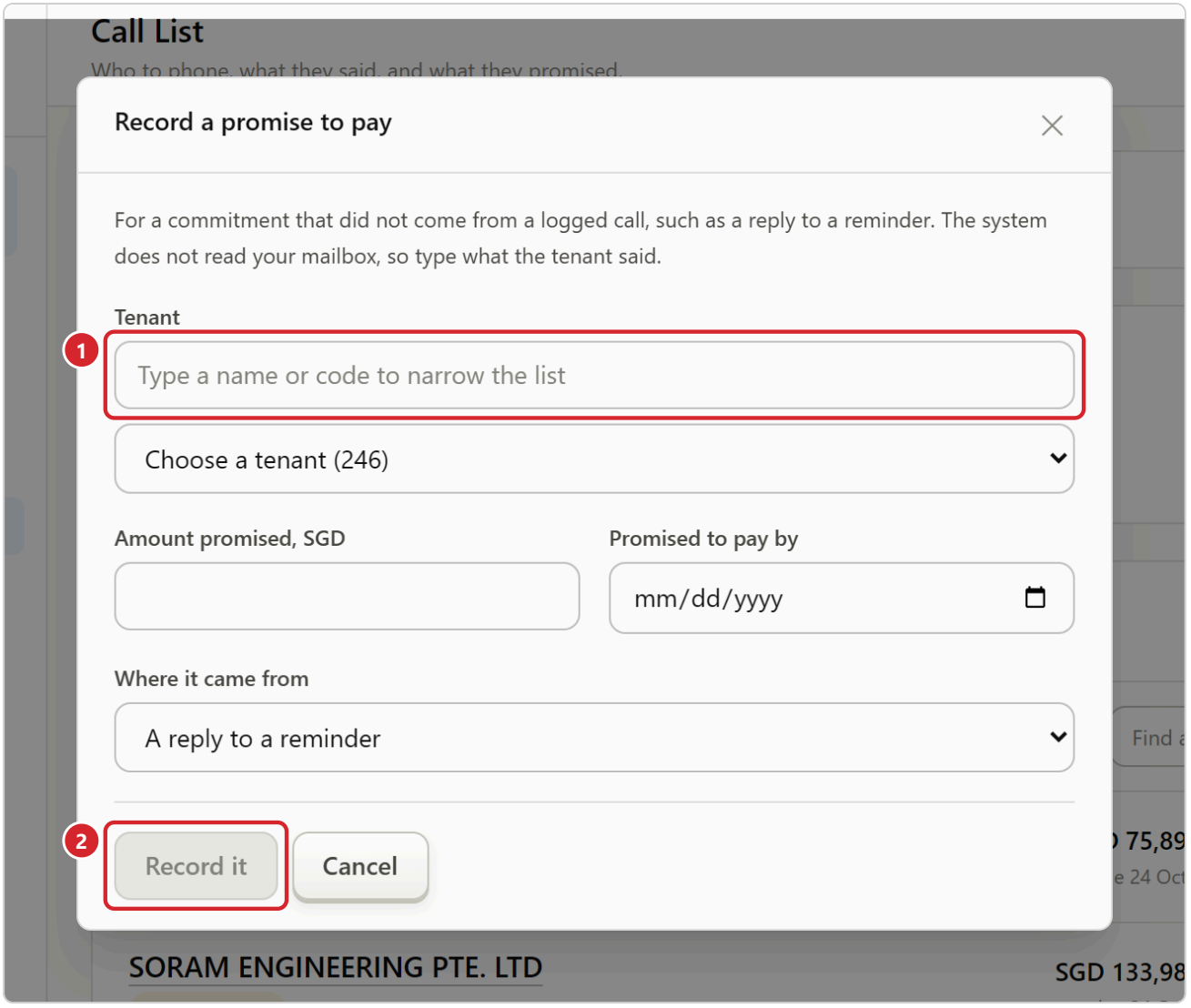


Figure 6.6 Recording a promise that did not come from a call.

1. Type to narrow the list of tenants, then choose one below.
2. **Record it** becomes available once the tenant, amount and date are filled in.

6.6 What happens in the background

- **The list follows the letters.** The first call is due once the first reminder date has passed. The second call is due once the final notice has really gone. For a tenant with no email address, the second call waits for the first call instead.
- **A promise takes the tenant off the list** until its date, and holds their letters too. They stay visible under Promised to pay so nobody rings them by mistake.
- **A promise that passes unpaid** moves to "Date passed, still unpaid" and counts towards Value at risk. The tenant comes back onto the list to phone.
- **A promise from a tenant who has since paid**, meaning they are gone from a newer report or owe nothing, is marked "Paid, no longer owing" and is not counted as money promised.
- **Every call and promise** is written to the Activity Log and goes into the NetSuite file on Reports and Export.
- **A Relationship Manager** sees and logs calls for their own tenants only.

7 Late Payment Fees

MES charges a late payment fee of S$100, before GST, on bills left unpaid more than 14 days past their due date. The 9am run raises the fees on the 16th of each month. This screen shows who is charged and why, gives you the listing for the AR team, and lets you raise the fees yourself if the run could not.

7.1 The screen

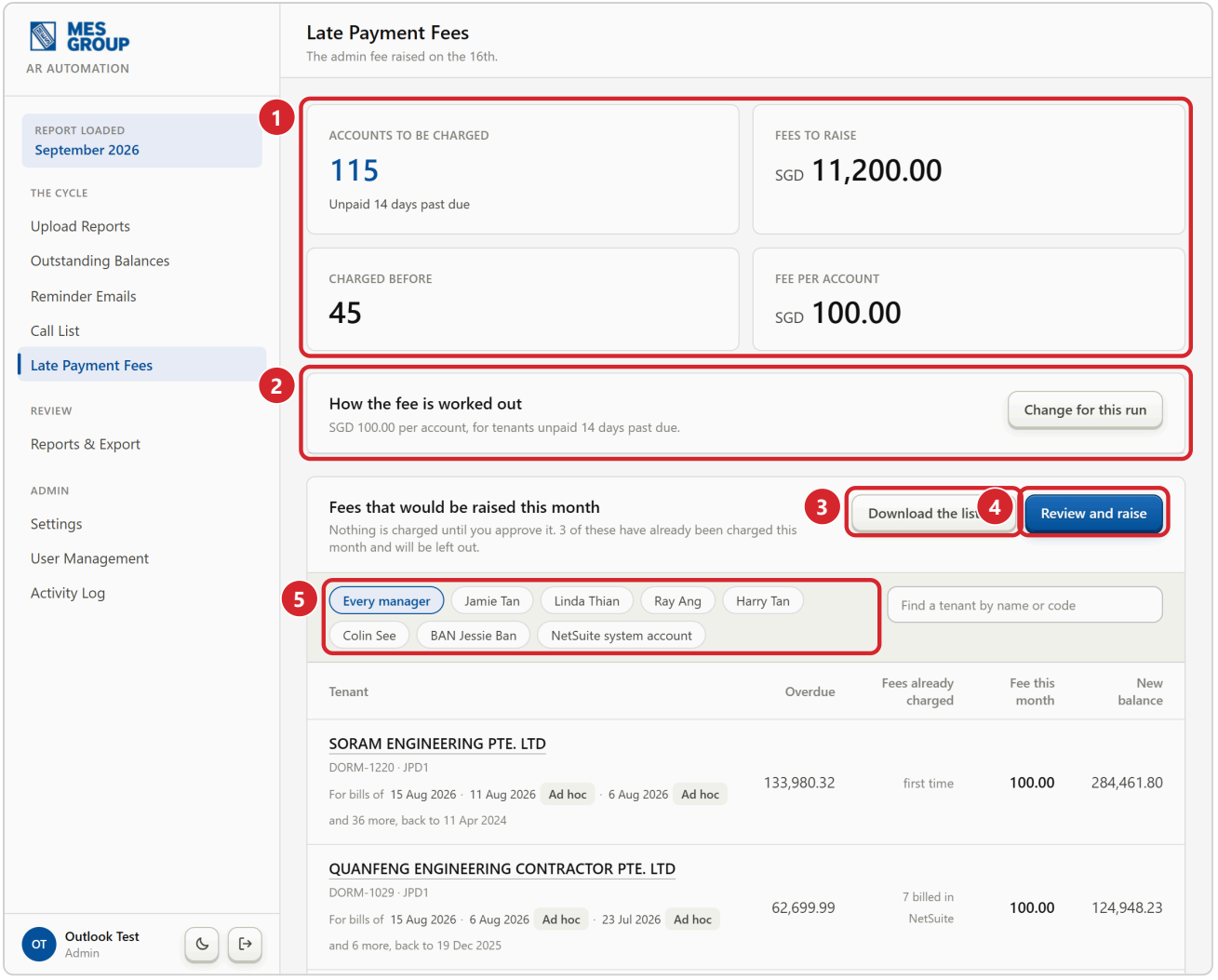


Figure 7.1 Late Payment Fees.

1. How many accounts would be charged, the total in fees, how many have been charged before, and the fee per account.
2. The rule being applied, in one line.
3. **Download the listing**: the spreadsheet for the AR team, including the GIRO tenants left out.
4. **Review and raise** the fees yourself (section 7.3).
5. Show every manager's tenants, or one manager's only.

7.2 Who is charged, and why

Each row in "Fees that would be raised this month" is one tenant.

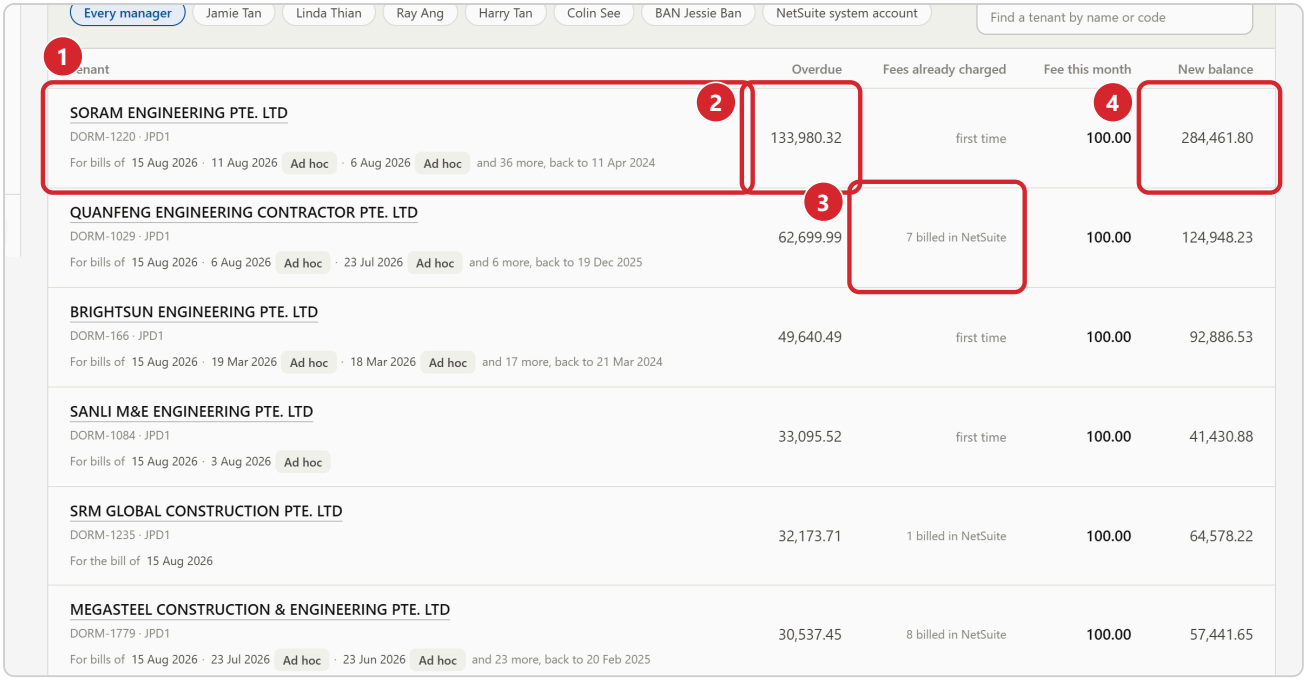


Figure 7.2 The tenants who would be charged.

1. The tenant, and the bills the fee is for. A bill dated on any day other than the 15th is marked Ad hoc. Only the newest three dates are listed, with how many more there are.
2. What they have overdue.
3. Fees charged before: "first time", or how many are already billed in NetSuite.
4. The fee this month, and their balance once it is added.

Below the list, two more boxes may appear.

- **Left out: on GIRO.** Tenants who have a Rejected GIRO Fee in the report. A bounced GIRO deduction is the bank's failure, not theirs, so they are not charged.
- **Settled: these tenants have since paid.** Tenants charged earlier who no longer owe. Press **Show** to list them.

7.3 Raising the fees yourself

Normally there is nothing to do: the 9am run raises the fees on the 16th. Raise them here only if the run did not, for example if the Activity Log shows the 16th was missed.

1. Check the list. Use the search box to find a tenant you are unsure about.
2. Press **Review and raise**. A window says how many fee notices will be raised and the total, and repeats the rule.
3. Press **Raise the fees**. The notice confirms how many were raised.

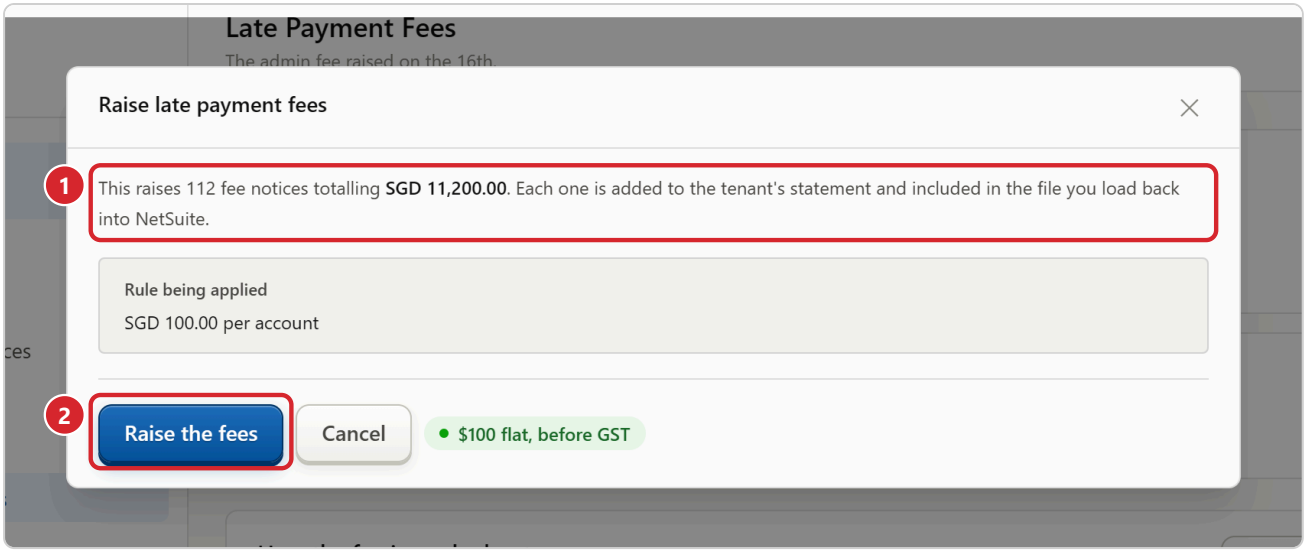


Figure 7.3 The last check before raising. Nothing is charged until Raise the fees is pressed.

1. How many fee notices will be raised, and the total.
2. **Raise the fees.** Press Cancel to leave without charging anyone.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
>
> A tenant can be charged only once a month. If some fees were already raised this month, by the 9am run or by someone else, the screen says how many and leaves them out, so pressing Raise the fees twice never charges anyone twice.

Changing the fee for one run

Change for this run lets you charge a different fixed amount or a percentage of what is overdue, or charge only tenants who owe more than a set amount. The change applies to fees raised from this screen, this time. It does not change the 9am run. To change when the 9am run charges, use Settings, Fees and reports (section 9.7).

7.4 What happens in the background

- **The rule.** On the 16th, a tenant is charged when they have a bill more than 14 days past its due date that is still unpaid. Settings can count from the billing date instead.
- **Invoice dates decide, not the aging columns.** MES counts anything up to 15 days past due as Current. On the 16th the month that has just gone unpaid is still in Current, so the system looks at each bill's own dates rather than the columns.
- **Once per tenant per month.** However many bills are late, the fee is S$100 once.
- **GIRO tenants are left out**, and tenants in credit are never charged.
- **Where a fee goes.** A raised fee is recorded against the tenant and appears on their page and in the Activity Log. The system does not change NetSuite itself: the AR team bills the fees there from the downloaded listing.

8 Reports and Export

Reports and Export is where information leaves the system: the file that takes calls, letters and promises back into NetSuite, the regular reports for CSD, management and each relationship manager, and any report emailed with its workbook attached.

8.1 The screen

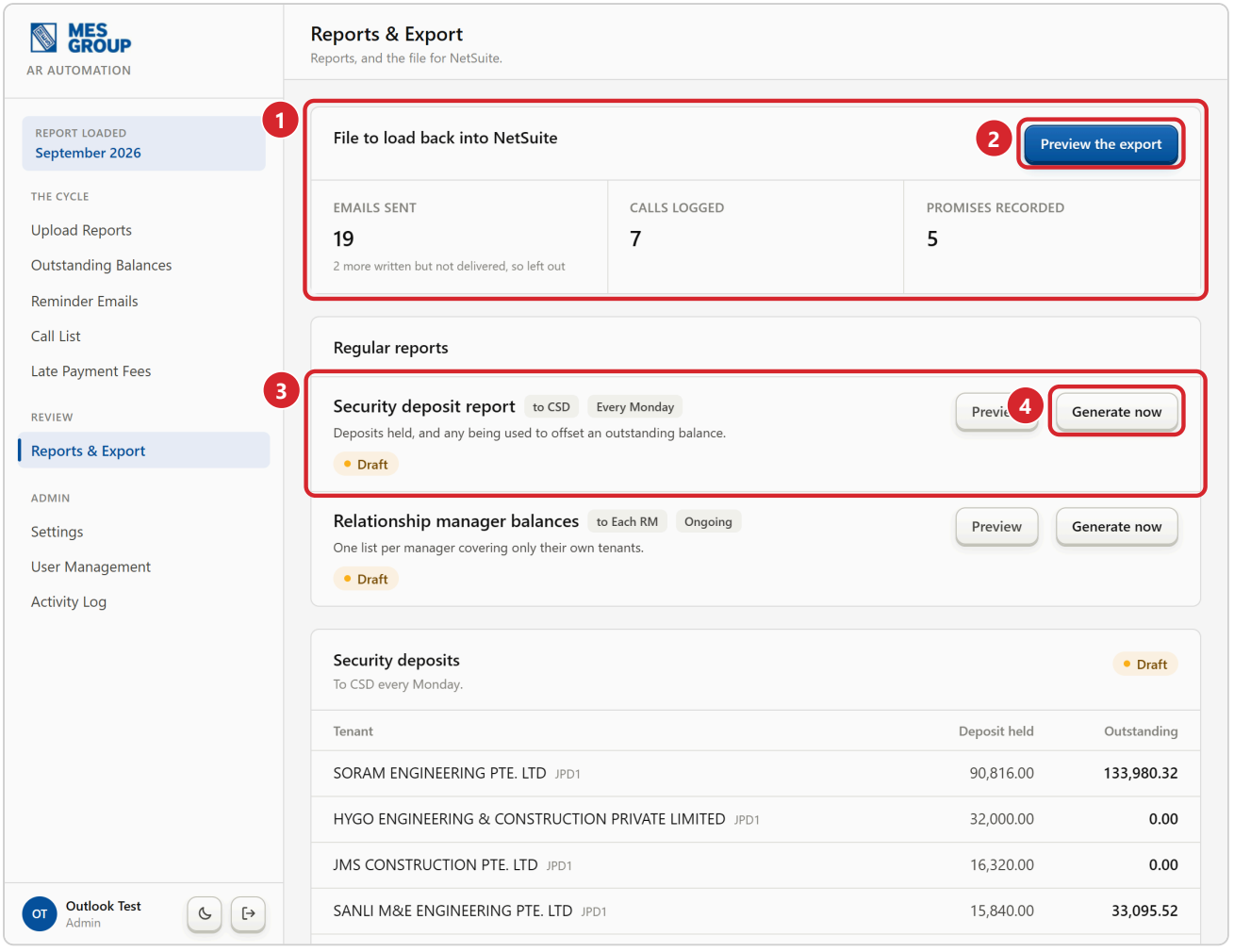


Figure 8.1 Reports and Export.

1. **The file for NetSuite**, with how many emails, calls and promises it holds.
2. **Preview the export** to read it and download it (section 8.2).
3. One regular report: who it is for and how often. Draft means MES has not yet confirmed its layout.
4. **Preview** shows what it contains. **Generate now** downloads it as a spreadsheet.

8.2 The file for NetSuite

Everything the team has done, one row per action: each email that was delivered, each call and each promise. Load it back into NetSuite so the tenant's record there shows the chase.

1. Press **Preview the export**.
2. Read the rows: date, tenant, what kind of action, what it was, and any amount.
3. Press **Download as CSV** and import the file into NetSuite.



Figure 8.2 The NetSuite export, before it is downloaded.

1. Date, tenant, type (Email, Call or Promise to pay), what it was, and the amount.
2. **Download as CSV**, the format NetSuite imports.

Letters that were written but never delivered are left out of the file, and the screen says how many. Late fees are not in this file. The AR team bills them in NetSuite from the listing on Late Payment Fees.

8.3 Regular reports

Report	For	What it shows
Security deposit report	CSD, every Monday	Deposits held, and any being used to offset an outstanding balance.
Relationship manager balances	Each manager	One list per manager, covering only their own tenants.
Industry breakdown	Management, first working day of the month	Balances grouped by the tenant's line of business. Shown only when the report has an industry column.

The system does not send these by itself. On the day, press **Generate now** to download the spreadsheet, or email it from Email a report.

Each manager's sheet

The Relationship manager balances box lists each manager with their number of tenants, what they owe and how much is overdue. **Open the sheet** shows that manager's tenants in MES's own layout, dormitory by dormitory.

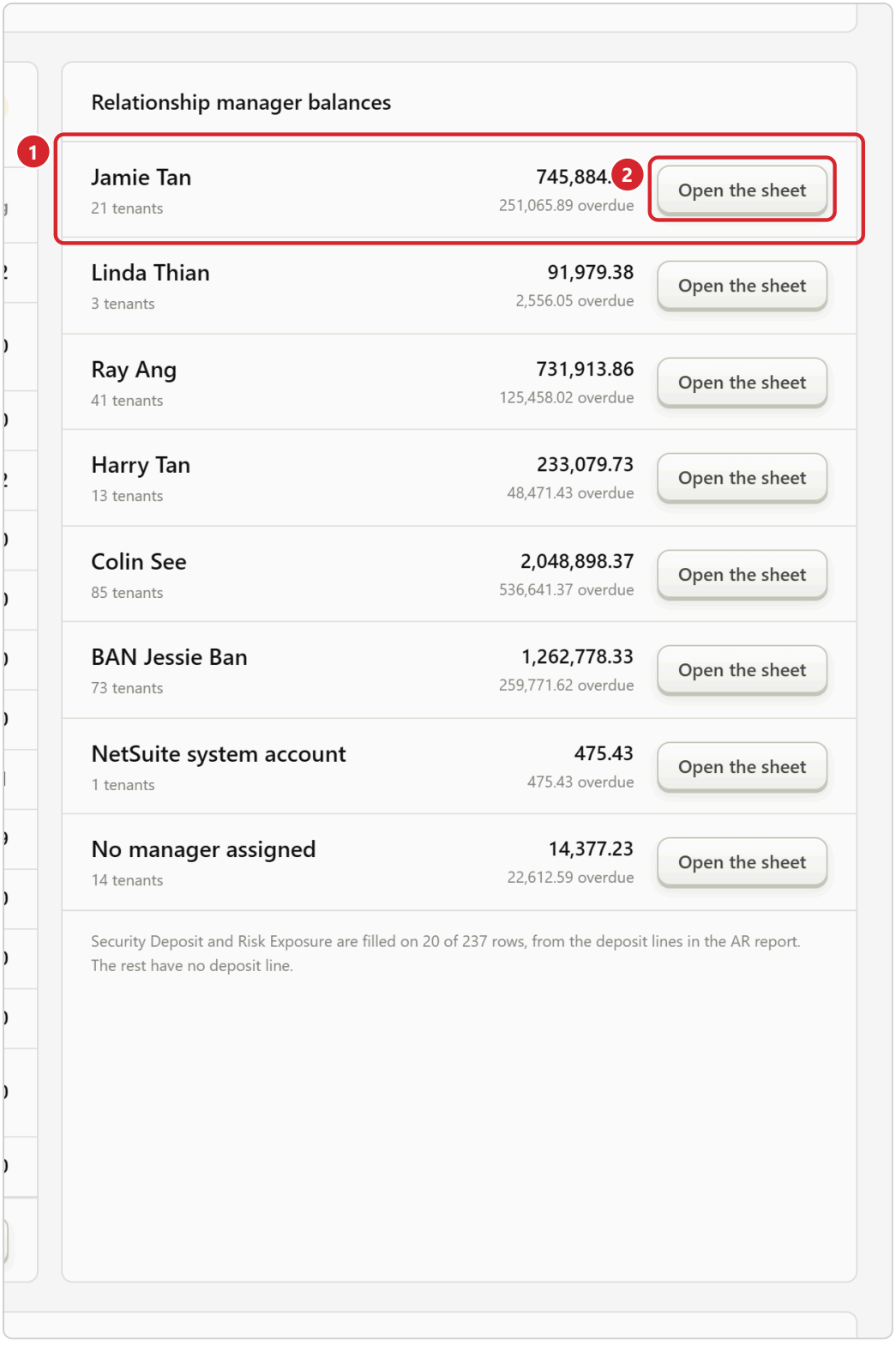


Figure 8.3 Each manager's book.

1. One manager: their tenants, what they owe in total and how much is overdue.
2. **Open the sheet** to read it.

Tenants with no manager in the report are grouped under "No manager assigned". "NetSuite system account" is NetSuite's own internal account, not a person.

8.4 Emailing a report

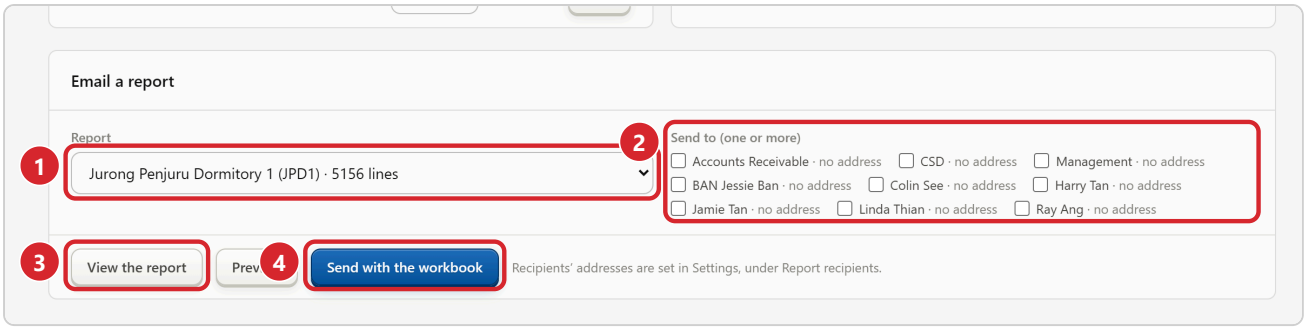


Figure 8.4 Email a report.

1. Which report: the whole dormitory, one charge type, or one manager's tenants.
2. Who to send it to. Tick one or more. "No address" means the address has not been filled in under Settings, Report recipients.
3. **View the report** to check the figures. **Preview** shows the covering email.
4. **Send with the workbook** emails it, with the spreadsheet attached.

1. Choose the report.
2. Tick who it goes to.
3. Press **View the report** and check it.
4. Press **Send with the workbook**. The notice says who it went to.

8.5 What happens in the background

- **Reports use the report in use.** Every figure is from the AR report on Upload Reports, laid out by dormitory and then by charge type, the order MES asked for.
- **What you preview is what is sent.** The workbook attached to an email is built by the same step as the download.
- **Recipients' addresses** come from Settings, Report recipients. The managers listed are the ones named in the report, so a new manager appears there on their own.
- **Every export and every report sent** is recorded in the Activity Log.
- **Nothing goes into NetSuite automatically.** The file only reaches NetSuite when someone imports it.

9 Settings

Settings holds the choices the 9am run works to: the mailbox letters go out from, when reminders are due, how the late fee is worked out, and who reports are emailed to. Only an Admin or Super Admin can open it. A saved change applies from the next 9am run, and every change is recorded in the Activity Log.

9.1 The five tabs

Tab	What it holds
Mailbox	The Outlook account letters are sent from, whether sending is switched on, and a test letter.
Reminder timing	How many days after billing the first reminder and the final notice go, and three choices about how they are counted.
Fees and reports	When the S$100 late fee applies, the regular billing day, and what to do when the report is old.
Report recipients	The email addresses reports are sent to.
Charge types	The rules that sort each charge into a type. Read only.

9.2 The Mailbox tab

Settings opens on Mailbox. This tab answers the question "why did nobody get the reminder?" without anyone having to guess.

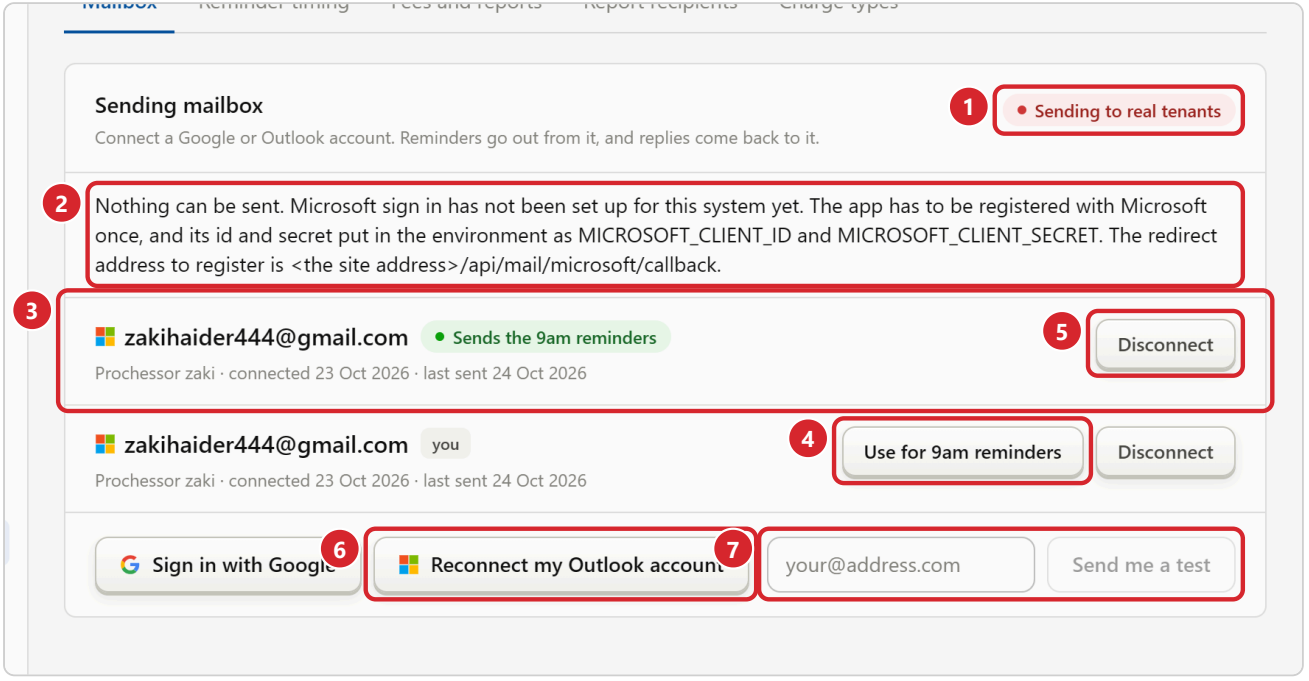


Figure 9.1 The Mailbox tab.

1. **Whether sending is on.** "Nothing is sent": letters are written and recorded, and no email leaves. "Test addresses only": only the test inboxes can receive mail. "Sending to real tenants": live.
2. **In plain words**, what happens right now and which address letters go out from. A problem shows here first.
3. **The mailbox the 9am run sends from**, marked "Sends the 9am reminders". Below the address: who connected it, when, and when it last sent.
4. **Use for 9am reminders** makes another connected mailbox the one the 9am run sends from.
5. **Disconnect** removes a mailbox. It can no longer send.
6. **Sign in with Microsoft** connects your Outlook account. Once connected it reads "Reconnect my Outlook account".
7. Type an address and press **Send me a test** to send a sample letter from the mailbox shown.

9.3 Connecting MES's Outlook mailbox

Letters go out from a real Outlook mailbox, and tenants' replies come back to it.

> **WHICH ACCOUNT TO CONNECT**
>
> Connect a team mailbox, such as the AR team's address, rather than one person's. Replies then reach the whole team, and nothing breaks when someone leaves. It must be a mailbox someone can sign in to with a password. A Microsoft 365 shared mailbox that nobody signs in to cannot be connected.

1. Sign in to MES AR Automation with your own login. Each login can have one mailbox connected.
2. Open Settings. On the Mailbox tab, press **Sign in with Microsoft**.
3. Microsoft's sign-in page opens. Sign in as the mailbox you want letters to come from, for example the AR team's address. This does not have to be your own account.
4. Microsoft asks you to allow MES AR Automation to sign you in and read your profile, send mail as you, and keep access to these. Press **Accept**. The system can send mail only. It cannot read the mailbox.
5. You are brought back to Settings. The notice "Connected" names the address, and the mailbox appears in the list.
6. If it is the first mailbox connected, it becomes the 9am mailbox straight away. If not, see the next section.

> **IF MICROSOFT SAYS "NEED ADMIN APPROVAL"**
>
> Some companies let only their IT administrator allow new apps. If that screen appears, ask MES's Microsoft 365 administrator to approve MES AR Automation for the organisation, in the Entra admin centre under Enterprise applications. Then try again.

9.4 Choosing which mailbox sends the 9am reminders

Several people can connect a mailbox, but the 9am run sends from one.

1. Find the mailbox in the list on the Mailbox tab.
2. Press **Use for 9am reminders** beside it. The notice says "The 9am run's reminders will come from" that address, and the "Sends the 9am reminders" label moves to it.

Which mailbox a letter comes from:

- Letters the 9am run sends come from the mailbox marked "Sends the 9am reminders".
- Letters you send yourself from Reminder Emails, and promise confirmations, come from your own mailbox if you have connected one, and from the 9am mailbox if you have not.
- Replies go to whichever mailbox sent the letter.
- Tenants see the sender's name as MES Group AR.

9.5 Sending a test letter

1. Type an address in the box at the bottom of the Mailbox tab.
2. Press **Send me a test**.
3. "Test sent" means it left, and names the mailbox it came from. "Nothing was sent" gives the reason. For example, while sending is set to test addresses only, an address that is not on the test list is refused.

9.6 When a mailbox needs reconnecting

Microsoft can stop accepting a connection after a password change, when access is removed, or after a long time unused. The mailbox's row then shows the reason in red, and Reminder Emails shows "Your mailbox needs reconnecting". Press **Reconnect my Outlook account** and sign in again. Nothing else changes.

SET OUTSIDE THIS SCREEN

Two things are set once by the system administrator in the hosting settings, not on this tab: the sending mode (off, test addresses only, or real tenants), and the connection to Microsoft that makes Sign in with Microsoft work. If that connection is missing, the tab says "Microsoft sign in has not been set up for this system yet". Chapter 14 covers both.

9.7 Reminder timing

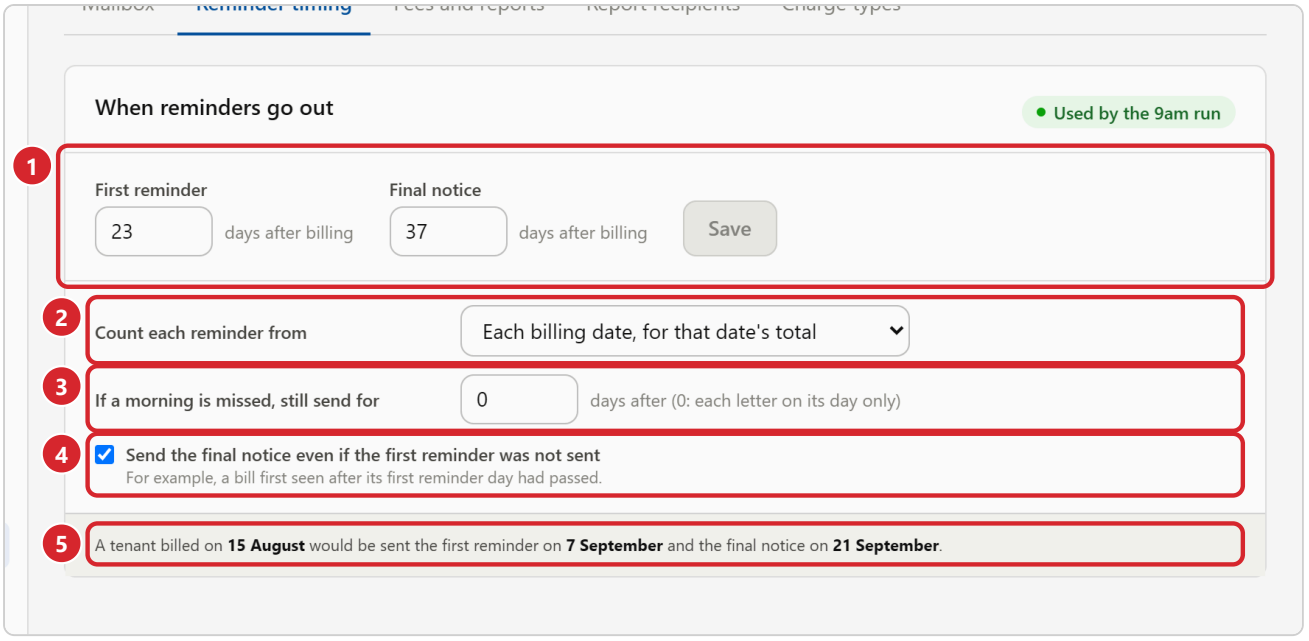


Figure 9.2 Reminder timing.

1. The first reminder and the final notice, in days after the billing date. The standard is 23 and 37. Press **Save** after changing them.
2. Count from each billing date, for that date's total (the standard), or from the newest bill only, for the whole balance.
3. How many days a letter may still go after its day, if the 9am run missed it. 0 means each letter goes on its day only.
4. Whether the final notice goes when no first reminder was sent, for example for a bill first seen after its first reminder day. On by standard.
5. A worked example that follows what you type, before you save.

The final notice must come after the first reminder. If it does not, the screen says "Cannot save".

9.8 Fees and reports

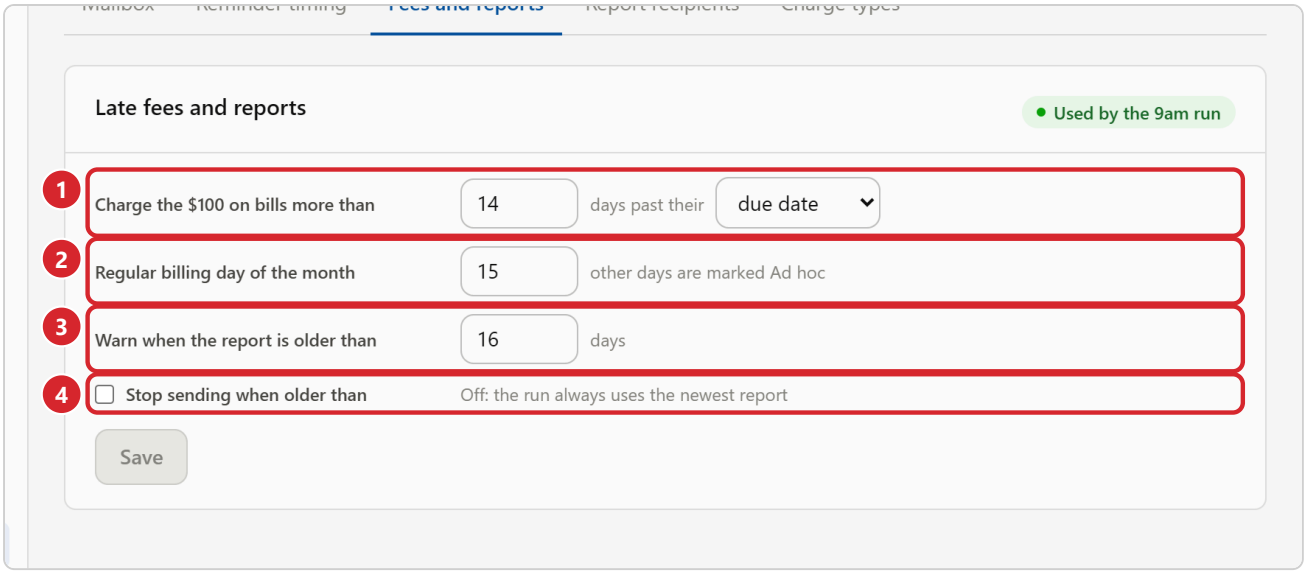


Figure 9.3 Fees and reports.

1. When the S$100 is charged: on bills more than 14 days past their due date, as standard. It can count from the billing date instead.
2. MES's regular billing day, the 15th. Bills dated on other days are marked Ad hoc.
3. After how many days without a new report the Activity Log warns, 16 as standard.
4. Optionally, stop sending letters and raising fees altogether when the report is older than a number of days. Off as standard.

9.9 Report recipients

The addresses reports are emailed to: the AR team, CSD, management, and each relationship manager named in the report. Type an address and press Enter, or click elsewhere, to save it. The label beside it changes from "No address" to "Ready". Leave a box empty for someone who should not receive reports.

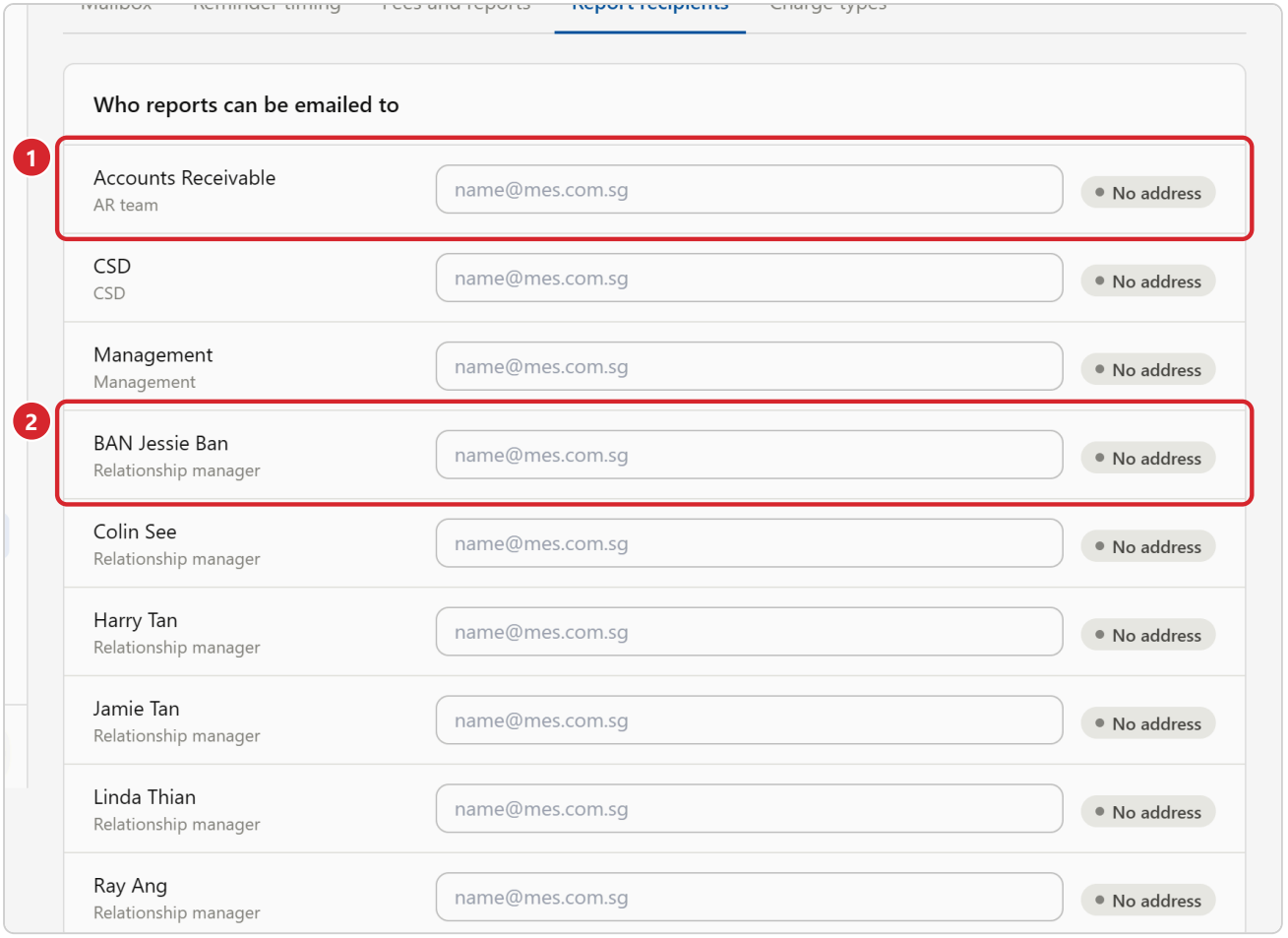


Figure 9.4 Report recipients.

1. One recipient, with the address reports go to and whether it is ready.
2. Each relationship manager named in the report has a row of their own.

9.10 Charge types

Each charge description in the AR report is sorted into a type, such as Occupancy Fee, VAT or Late Payment Fee, by the rules on this tab. They are checked in order, and the first that matches wins. Anything that matches none is Other Charges, and is listed by name after every upload so a new wording is seen straight away. The rules are read only. To change one, ask the system administrator.

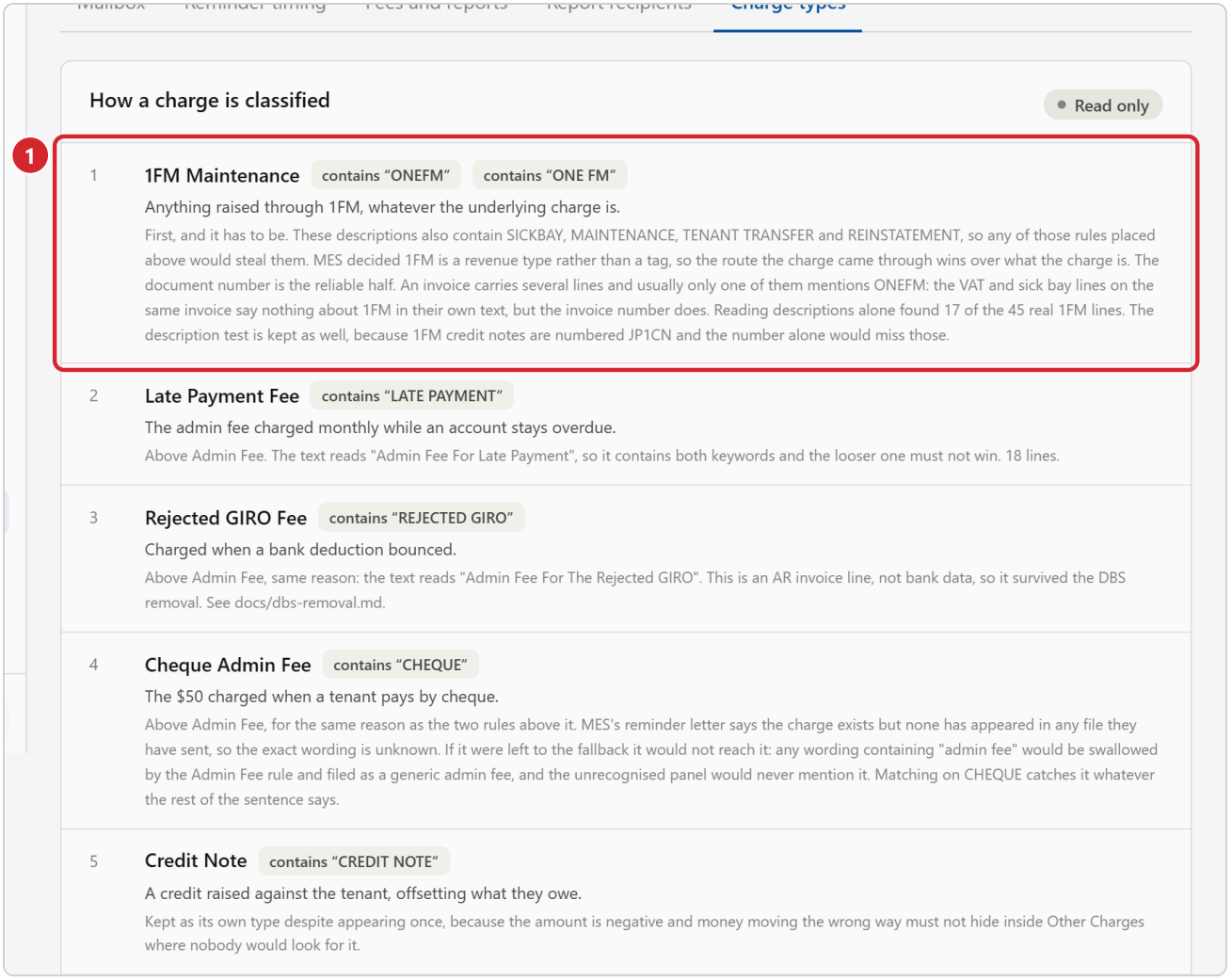


Figure 9.5 The first of the charge type rules.

1 One rule: the type, the words that identify it, and what it means.

9.11 What happens in the background

- **One copy of each setting** is kept centrally. Every screen and the 9am run read the same one, so a change on one computer applies everywhere.
- **Changes are recorded.** Each save writes an entry in the Activity Log with who changed what.
- **Changes apply forward.** A change to timing affects letters from the next 9am run. Letters already sent are not sent again.
- **Until timing is first saved**, the 9am run uses the standard 23 and 37 days, and the tab says "Built-in default".

10 User Management

User Management is where an administrator gives people a login, sets their role, and switches a login off when someone leaves. Only an Admin or Super Admin can open it.

10.1 The screen

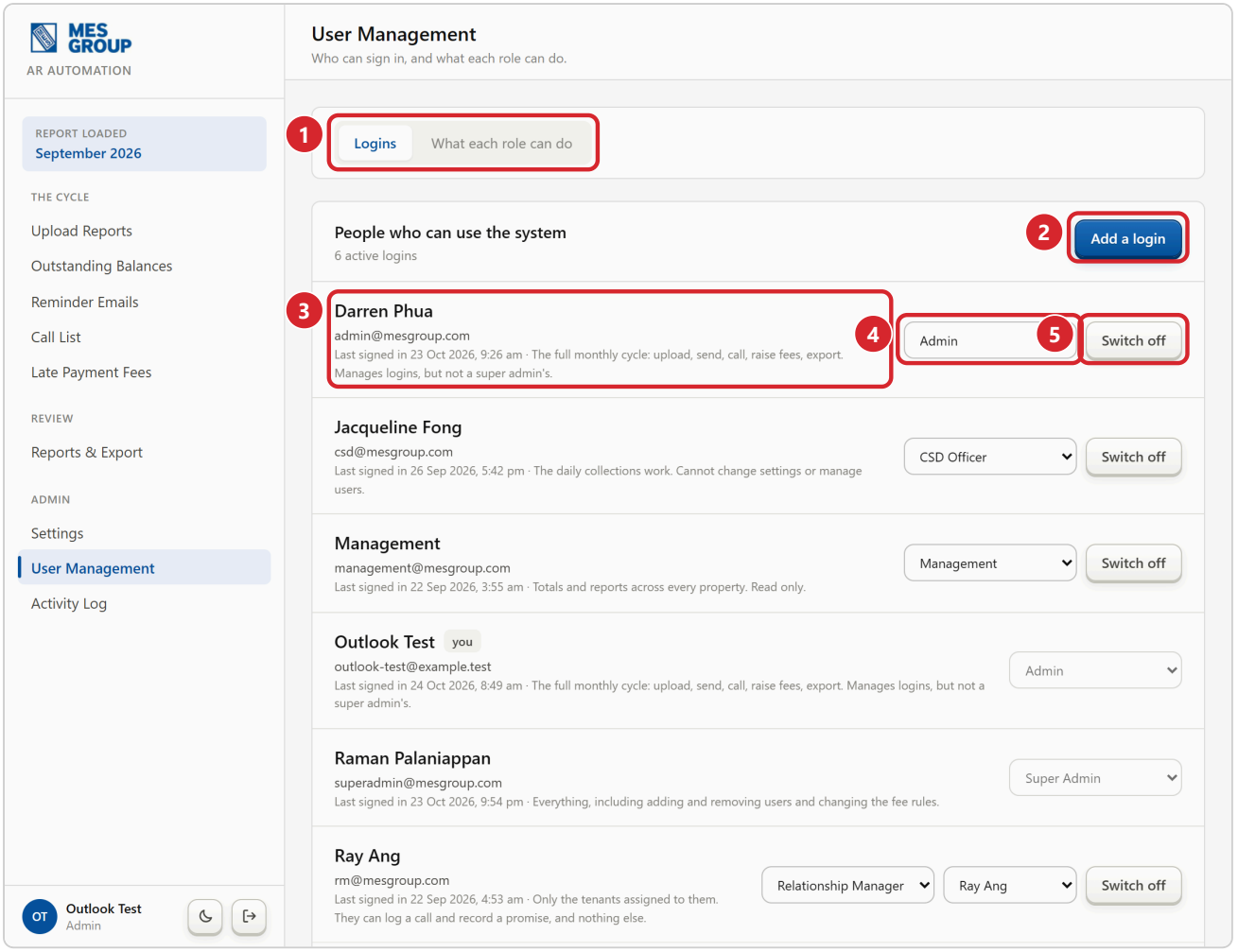


Figure 10.1 User Management, on the Logins tab.

1. **Logins**, or **What each role can do** (chapter 2, figure 2.3).
2. **Add a login** for a new person.
3. The person's name, their email address, when they last signed in, and what their role allows.
4. Their role. Choosing another one changes it straight away.
5. **Switch off** stops them signing in.

10.2 Adding a login

1. Press **Add a login**.
2. Type the person's full name and their email address. The email address is their username.
3. Choose their role. The line below the role says what it allows.

4. For a Relationship Manager, choose whose tenants they see. The list is the managers named in the AR report.
5. A first password is filled in for you. You can type your own instead, of at least 10 characters.
6. Press **Create the login**.
7. Give the person their email address and first password yourself. Nothing is emailed to them.

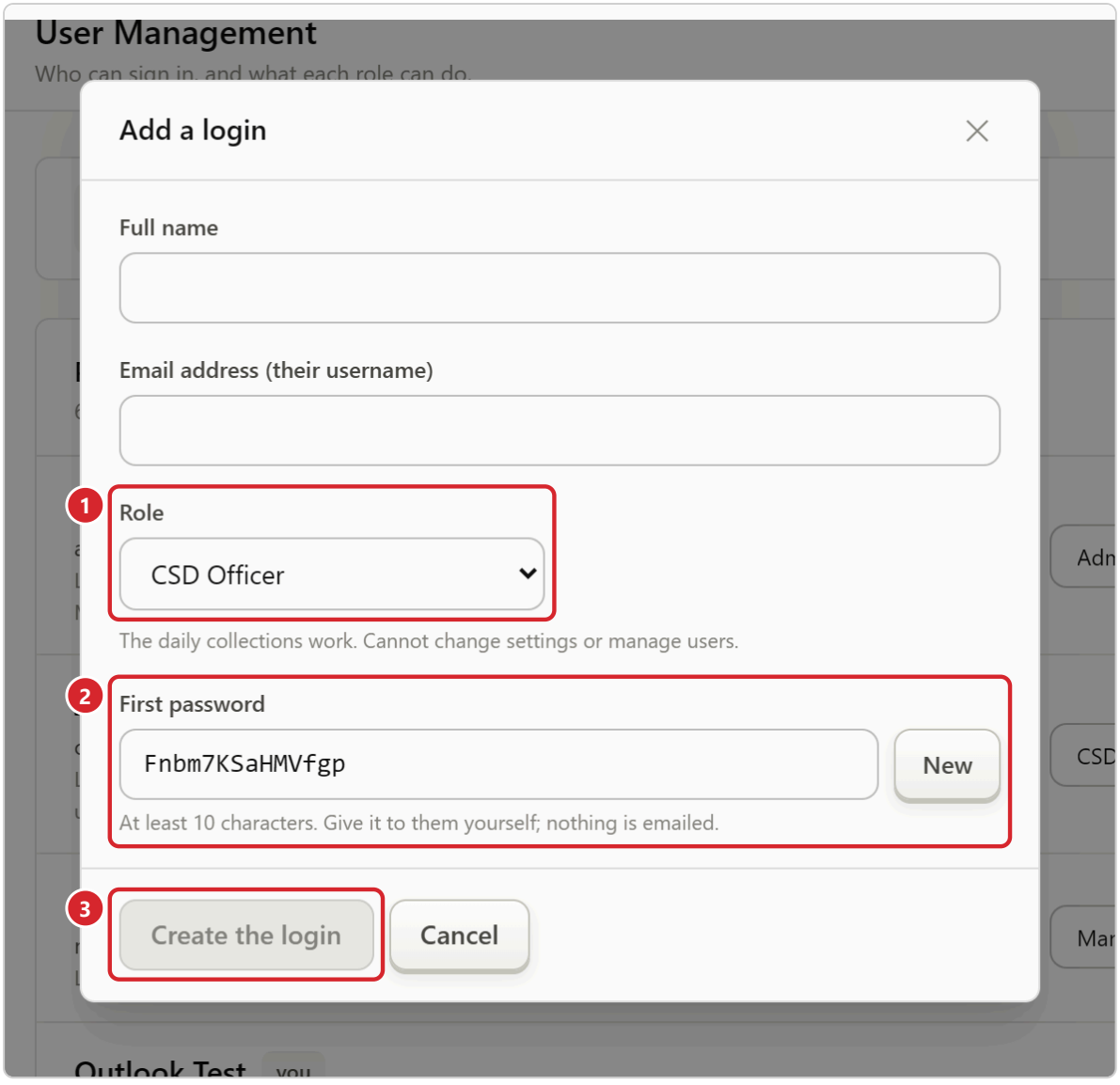


Figure 10.2 Adding a login.

1. The role, with what it allows written beneath.
2. The first password. **New** makes another one. It avoids letters that are easy to misread, such as 0 and O.
3. **Create the login.** It becomes available once the name, email and password are filled in.

10.3 Changing a role

Choose the new role in the drop-down on the person's row. The change is saved at once, and the notice says what they are now. For a Relationship Manager, a second drop-down chooses whose tenants they see.

Two limits apply. Nobody can change their own role, and an Admin cannot change, or switch off, a Super Admin.

10.4 Switching a login off

When someone leaves, press **Switch off** on their row. They can no longer sign in, and the row is marked "Switched off". Their name stays on everything they did, so the history is still readable. Press **Switch on** to let them back in.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> Logins are never deleted, only switched off. That way the Activity Log can always say who did what.

10.5 What happens in the background

- **Passwords are kept by the sign-in service**, never by the system itself, and are never emailed.
- **A role is checked on every action**, not only on what the menu shows.
- **A Relationship Manager's tenants** are the ones the AR report names them as manager for. If the report moves a tenant to another manager, the tenant moves with it.
- **Every login added, changed or switched off** is recorded in the Activity Log with who did it.

11 Activity Log and the 9am runs

The Activity Log records everything that has been done, by a person or by the 9am run, with who did it and when. Nothing in it can be edited or deleted. Its second tab shows what each morning's run did, and anything that needs a hand is shown at the top.

11.1 Everything that has been done

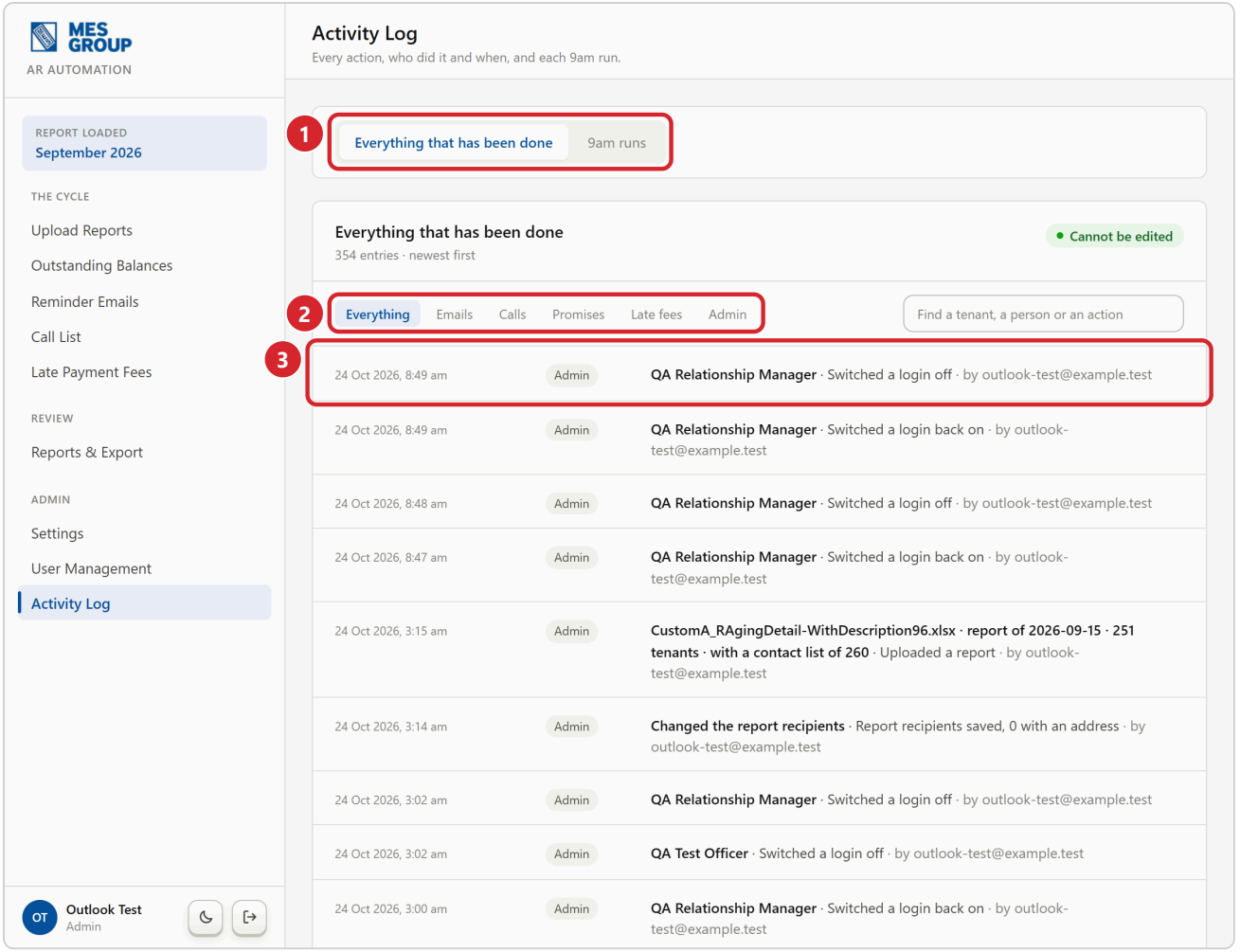


Figure 11.1 The Activity Log.

1. **Everything that has been done**, or **9am runs**.
2. Show everything, or only emails, calls, promises, late fees or admin actions. The box beside it finds a tenant, a person or an action.
3. One entry: when, what kind, what was done and to whom, and who did it.

Admin entries include uploading a report, changing a setting or the report recipients, adding or switching off a login, and sending a report. Entries are newest first, and the number at the top says how many there are in all.

11.2 Needs attention

When a 9am run has missed something, a Needs attention box appears above the log. Each item says what was missed and has a button to put it right.

It says	Press
Today's reminders have not gone out	Run this morning now
No run on certain dates	Run that date again, to send the letters due that day
The run stopped, or ran out of time before some letters	Send the remaining letters
Late fees for a month were not raised	Raise that month's late fees

Each button asks you to confirm first and says what it will do. These send real letters to tenants and raise real fees. Tenants who already had their letter are skipped, and no fee is charged twice.

11.3 The 9am runs tab

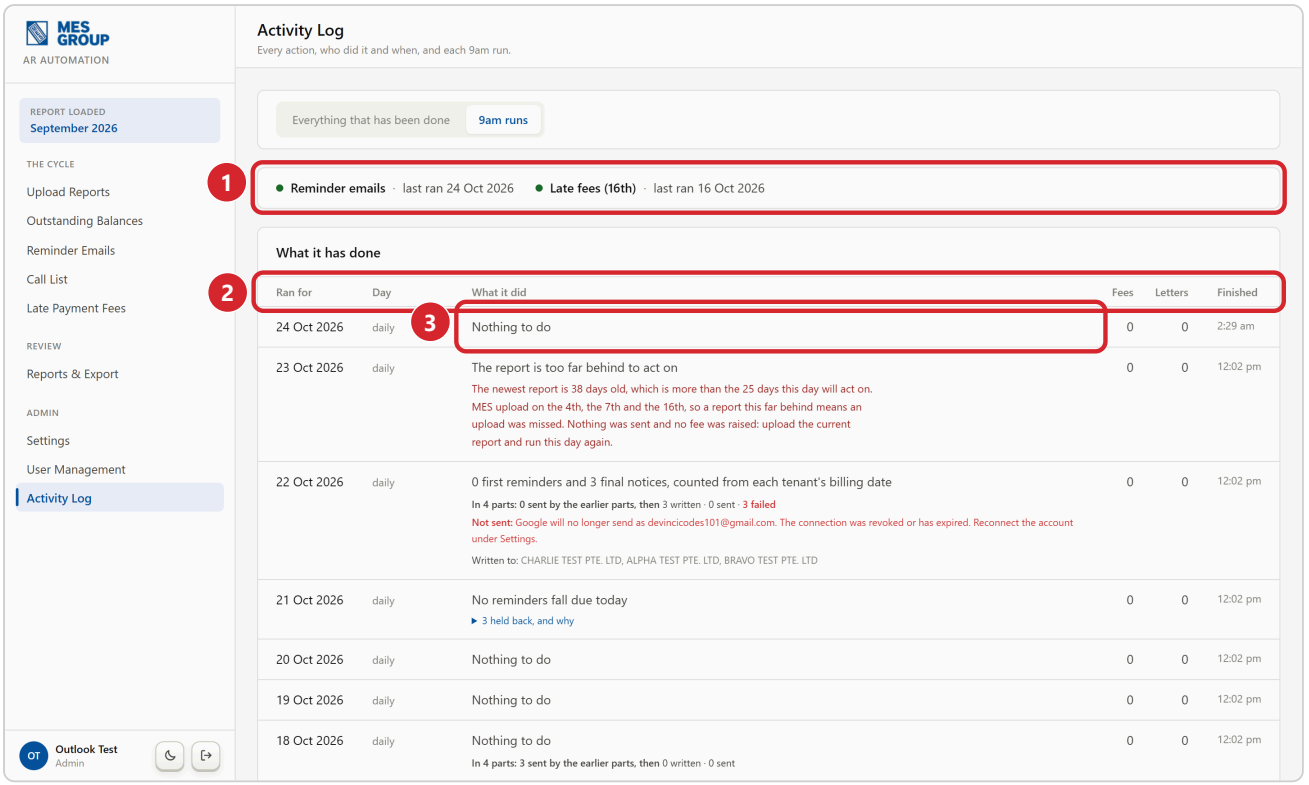


Figure 11.2 What each morning's run did.

1. When the reminders last ran, and when the 16th's late fees last ran.
2. One row per morning: the date, which day of the cycle it was, what it did, how many fees and letters, and when it finished.
3. What it did, in words. Open a row's details to see who was written to, who was held back and why.

What the "What it did" column can say:

It says	Meaning
Nothing to do	No letters fell due and it was not the 16th.
No reminders fall due today	As above, sometimes with tenants held back by a promise.
N first reminders and N final notices	The letters written that morning, then how many were sent, held back or failed, with the reason.
Held back: test mode	Sending was on test addresses only, so letters to real tenants were written but not sent.
Not sent: the connection was revoked	The mailbox needs reconnecting (chapter 9).
In N parts	A long list was sent in parts, at 9am and the follow-up runs after it.
Late payment fees, Charged N tenants	The 16th's fees were raised.
The report is too far behind to act on	Shown only when Settings is set to stop on an old report. Upload the current report and run that day again.

11.4 What happens in the background

- **The log is permanent.** Entries can be added but never changed or deleted, by anyone.
- **The 9am run starts by itself** at 9am Singapore time. If it has more to send than fits in one go, follow-up runs at 10am, 11am and noon carry on from where it stopped.
- **Running a day twice is safe.** Letters already sent are skipped and fees already raised are not raised again.
- **Management can read the log**, and so can CSD officers. Relationship Managers cannot.

12 What happens in the background

This chapter explains how the system turns an AR report into letters, calls and fees. None of it needs doing by hand. It is here so you can answer "why did this tenant get that letter" and check the system is doing what MES expects.

12.1 The 9am run, step by step

Every morning at 9am Singapore time the system runs on its own, whether or not anyone is signed in. In order, it:

1. Reads the newest saved AR report, the settings, every letter already sent, every promise to pay, and any letters edited for a tenant.
2. Checks how old the report is. If it is more than 16 days old, it carries on and notes a warning. If Settings says to stop on an old report, it stops here.
3. Works out which letters fall due today, one bill at a time (section 12.2).
4. Leaves out tenants who have already had that letter for that bill, tenants with a promise to pay that has not fallen due, and tenants who owe nothing or are in credit.
5. Puts each tenant's letters for the day into one email, using the edited wording where someone has saved an edit.
6. Sends the tenants with no email address to the By hand list instead.
7. Records each letter as written, then sends it from the nominated mailbox, in small batches. A letter is marked sent only once the mail server accepts it.
8. On the 16th, raises the late payment fees (section 12.3).
9. Records what it did on the 9am runs tab of the Activity Log. Anything it could not do appears in Needs attention.

If there is more to send than fits in one go, follow-up runs at 10am, 11am and noon carry on from where it stopped.

12.2 How a reminder date is worked out

Each billing date has its own clock. The first reminder goes 23 days after the billing date, and the final notice 37 days after it. Here is one tenant with two bills.

Bill	Billed	Amount	First reminder	Final notice
Monthly bill	15 Aug	S$5,000	7 Sep, asks for S$5,000	21 Sep, asks for S$5,000
Ad hoc bill	3 Sep	S$200	26 Sep, asks for S$200	10 Oct, asks for S$200

If both bills fell due the same letter on the same day, the tenant would get one email asking for S$5,200. If the tenant pays the August bill, the next report no longer has it, and the September letters ask only for what

is left.

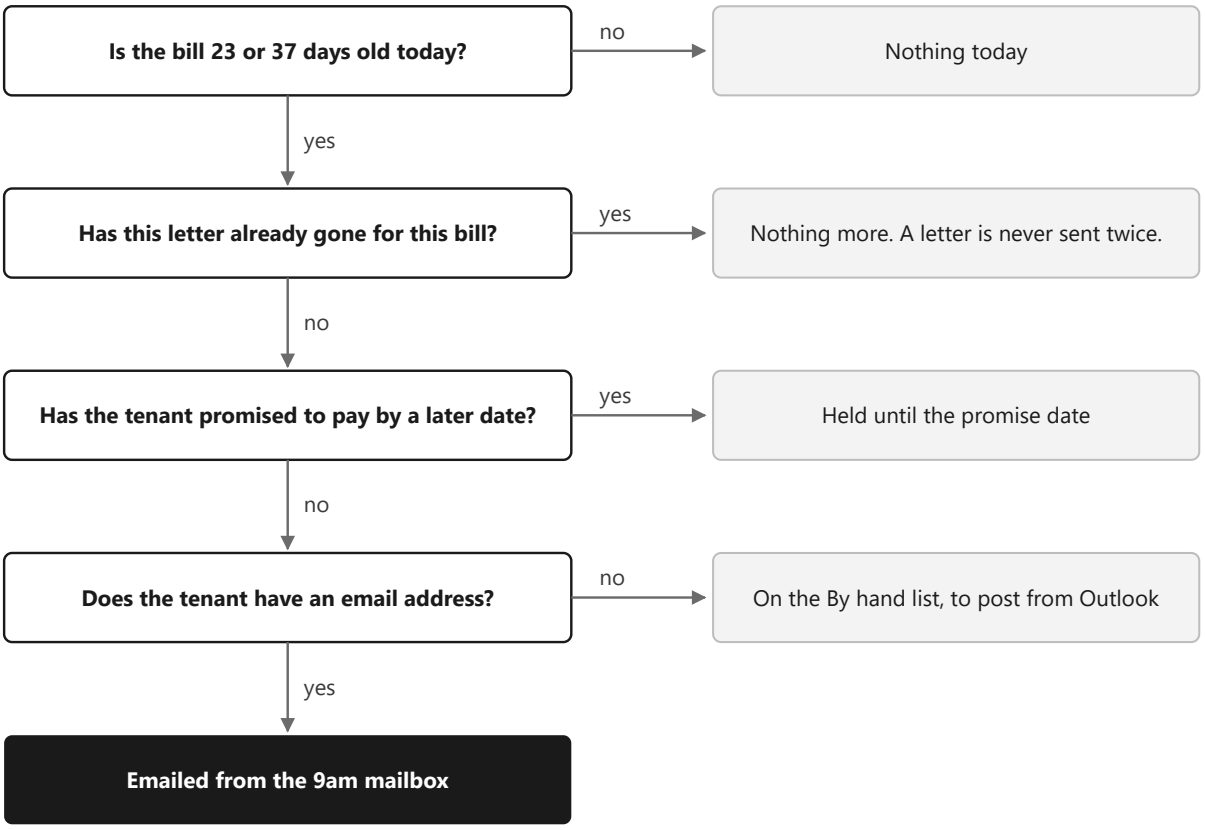


Figure 12.1 How the 9am run decides, for one bill, whether a letter goes today.

Three settings change the picture (Settings, Reminder timing):

- **Count from the newest bill only.** Instead of one clock per billing date, only the tenant's newest bill starts the clock, and the letter asks for the whole balance.
- **Days of grace.** Normally a letter goes on its day only. With grace days set, a letter the run missed still goes on the days after.
- **Final notice without a first reminder.** On by standard, so a bill first seen after its first reminder day still gets its final notice. Turned off, the final notice waits for a first reminder that was really sent.

12.3 How the late fee is worked out

On the 16th, every tenant with a bill more than 14 days past its due date, and still unpaid, is charged S$100 before GST, once. The due date is the one in the report, or 14 days after billing if the report has none.

Bill	Due	On 16 September
Billed 15 August	29 August	18 days past due, so charged
Billed 1 September	15 September	1 day past due, so not yet. Charged on 16 October if still unpaid.

A tenant is not charged if they pay by GIRO (they have a Rejected GIRO Fee line in the report), if they are in credit, or if they have already been charged this month. Settings can count the 14 days from the billing date instead of the due date.

12.4 How charges are sorted into types

Each line of the AR report has a description, such as "Service & Conservancy Charges". The rules under Settings, Charge types are checked in order, and the first that matches decides the type. A line that matches none is Other Charges. After every upload, any description that landed in Other Charges is listed by name, so a new kind of charge is noticed straight away. The types are used for the charge type table on Outstanding Balances, the reports, and to recognise GIRO tenants and 1FM Maintenance tenants.

12.5 What happens when a report is replaced

- **Everything is recalculated from the new report:** balances, aging, who is due a letter or a call, and the fee list.
- **A tenant not in the new report has paid in full.** Their letters stop and their promises are marked paid.
- **Work already done is kept:** letters sent, calls, promises, fees raised and addresses typed in by hand.
- **A letter already sent for a bill is not sent again** because a new report still has that bill.
- **The same report date replaces.** A corrected export with the same date takes the place of the first one.

12.6 Sending safely

A letter reaches a tenant only when three things are true: a mailbox is connected, Microsoft still accepts it, and sending is switched on. Each one is shown on Settings, Mailbox. Sending has three modes, set by the system administrator:

Mode	What happens
Nothing is sent	Letters are written and recorded, and no email leaves.
Test addresses only	Only addresses on the test list receive mail. Letters to anyone else are written, held back, and recorded as held back.
Sending to real tenants	Letters go to the tenants' own addresses. This is the live setting.

Every letter is recorded before it is sent and marked sent only afterwards, so the Activity Log always shows exactly what went and what did not.

13 How to test the system

Use these checks to confirm the system works before trusting it with real tenants, and again after any change to the system or its settings. Each test says what to do and what you should see. Tick the box when it matches. If it does not, write down what you saw and when, and send it to the system administrator.

13.1 Before you start

Testing must never reach a real tenant. Check all of these first.

1. **Sending is on test addresses only.** On Settings, Mailbox, the label reads "Test addresses only" and the line below lists the test inboxes. If it reads "Sending to real tenants", stop and ask the system administrator to switch it back.
2. **Use the test files** kept with this manual in `docs/manual/samples`: a shortened AR report of 15 tenants, a contact list whose addresses are all test inboxes, and a file that is not a report.
3. **Have a login for each role:** Admin, CSD Officer, Relationship Manager and Management.
4. **Note the report in use** on Upload Reports before you start, so you can put it back.

> **CAREFUL**
>
> Saving a test report replaces the report everyone sees, and a raised fee is real. Test on a day nobody else is working in the system, and upload the current NetSuite report again when you finish (test U10).

13.2 Signing in and roles

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
S1	Sign in with a wrong password.	You stay on the sign-in page, with a message under the boxes.	☐
S2	Sign in as Admin.	Outstanding Balances. The menu has The cycle, Review and Admin, and your name and role are at the bottom.	☐
S3	Sign in as CSD Officer.	The same menu without Settings and User Management.	☐
S4	Sign in as Relationship Manager.	Only Outstanding Balances and Call List, showing only that manager's tenants. No email addresses anywhere.	☐
S5	As Relationship Manager, type the address of Settings into the browser.	You are taken back to Outstanding Balances.	☐

S6	Sign in as Management.	Outstanding Balances, Reports and Export and the Activity Log only. Nothing can be sent or changed.	☐
S7	Press the moon button, then press it again.	The screens switch to dark and back to light.	☐
S8	Sign out.	The sign-in page.	☐

13.3 Uploading a report

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
U1	Open Upload Reports.	The Report in use box gives the month, the number of tenants and invoice lines, and the report date.	☐
U2	Choose `not-a-report.csv` as the AR report and press Read the file.	"Nothing usable. Neither file could be read as an AR report." The checks say "Do not use this data", and there is no Use this report button.	☐
U3	Press Remove file. Choose the sample AR report and press Read the file.	Billing month October 2026. The totals show 15 tenant accounts with 1 in credit, SGD 195,443.08 owed and 135 invoice lines.	☐
U4	Read Checks on this upload.	"Usable, but read these first", with "No contact list in this upload" among the warnings.	☐
U5	Add the sample contact list and press Read the file again.	The contact list warning is gone and Can be emailed is above 0.	☐
U6	In Compared with the report of, open New bills.	The new invoices, grouped by billing date. Dates other than the 15th are marked Ad hoc.	☐
U7	Go to another screen and come back to Upload Reports.	The files and the comparison are still there. Nothing was saved.	☐
U8	Press Use this report.	"Saved. Everyone signed in now sees this report." Report in use and the menu show the new month.	☐
U9	Open the Activity Log.	"Uploaded a report", with your name, the file and the time.	☐
U10	Upload the current NetSuite report and press Use this report.	The real report is in use again. Calls and promises from before are still there.	☐

13.4 Outstanding Balances

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
B1	Open Outstanding Balances.	The four totals, and tenants listed most overdue first, with the report date under Tenants.	☐

B2	Type part of a tenant's name in the search box.	Only matching tenants.	☐
B3	Press Overdue, then All.	The count on each matches the list.	☐
B4	Press Aging columns, then click the 90 days heading twice.	The list sorts by that column, then the other way round.	☐
B5	Press + on a row.	That tenant's invoice lines open under the row.	☐
B6	Open Show charge types and billing runs.	The total at the foot of By charge type equals Total owed at the top.	☐
B7	On a test tenant with no email, press No email, add one, type a test inbox and press Enter.	"Email saved". The tenant leaves the By hand list on Reminder Emails.	☐
B8	Click a tenant's name.	Their page: totals, everything done for them, and every charge line.	☐

13.5 Reminder Emails

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
R1	Open Reminder Emails.	Five tabs. The counts on First reminder and Final notice match their lists.	☐
R2	Open All tenants. Pick a tenant billed on the 15th of last month.	First reminder 23 days after billing and final notice 37 days after, as in Settings.	☐
R3	Click one of the Where they stand filters.	Only those bills, and the count matches.	☐
R4	Press Edit letter on a test tenant. Change a sentence, open the preview, and press Save for the automatic send.	The preview shows the change with the amount filled in. The row is marked Edited.	☐
R5	Edit the letter again and change {{amount}} to {{amont}}.	Save stays greyed out, and a message lists the words it fills in.	☐
R6	Press Back to the standard wording.	The Edited mark is gone.	☐
R7	On a day a letter is due to a test tenant, open First reminder and press Read and send, then Send this email.	The letter arrives in the test inbox, from MES Group AR, asking for that billing date's total. It moves to the Sent tab.	☐
R8	Open the Sent tab and click a letter.	The letter exactly as sent, with who it went to and when.	☐
R9	Open By hand and press Download the list.	A spreadsheet of the tenants with no address.	☐
R10	On a day a by-hand letter is due, open it, press Copy, then I have sent this by hand.	The letter is copied. The tenant moves to Sent by hand with today's date.	☐

13.6 The 9am run

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
N1	The morning after setting up a test tenant whose bill is 23 days old, open Activity Log, 9am runs.	A row for today saying how many first reminders were written and sent.	☐
N2	Check the test inbox.	The first reminder arrived around 9am.	☐
N3	Look for real tenants in that row.	Any letters to addresses not on the test list are "held back" with the reason test mode.	☐
N4	Open Reminder Emails, All tenants, for that test tenant.	"First reminder sent" with today's date.	☐
N5	If Needs attention shows a missed morning, press its button and confirm.	The missed letters go, and tenants who already had theirs are skipped.	☐

13.7 Call List and promises

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
C1	Open Call List.	Tenants past their first reminder date, each saying which call it is and why.	☐
C2	Press Log this call on a test tenant and try to save without choosing what happened.	It will not save until an outcome is chosen.	☐
C3	Choose Nobody answered and save.	"Call with ... saved". The tenant shows under Already called, and in Calls logged.	☐
C4	Press View the call on it.	Every answer as it was entered.	☐
C5	Log another call, choose Agreed to pay, and try a date in the past.	The date is refused.	☐
C6	Choose a date next week and save.	"added to Payment Promises". The tenant shows under Promised to pay.	☐
C7	Open Payment promises.	The promise under Coming up, and Value promised includes it.	☐
C8	Press Send confirmation on it.	The test inbox gets a short confirmation. The promise reads "Confirmed to tenant".	☐
C9	Press Record a promise, choose a tenant, an amount, a date and "A reply to a reminder", and press Record it.	The promise is listed, made "in a reply to a reminder".	☐
C10	Open Reminder Emails, All tenants, for that tenant.	"Promised to pay by" the date. No letter goes before it.	☐

13.8 Late Payment Fees

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
F1	Open Late Payment Fees.	Accounts to be charged times SGD 100 equals Fees to raise, less any already charged this month.	☐
F2	Find a tenant whose only unpaid bill is less than 14 days past due.	They are not on the list.	☐
F3	Look at Left out: on GIRO.	Each tenant there has a Rejected GIRO Fee in the report.	☐
F4	Press Download the listing.	A spreadsheet of the fees, including the GIRO tenants left out.	☐
F5	Press Review and raise, then Cancel.	The window shows the count and total, and nothing is raised.	☐
F6	After the 16th, open Activity Log, 9am runs.	A 16th row, "Charged" with the tenants named. Late Payment Fees now says they have been charged this month.	☐

13.9 Reports and Export

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
X1	Open Reports and Export.	The counts of emails, calls and promises match what was done in the tests above.	☐
X2	Press Preview the export, then Download as CSV.	One row per action, and the file downloads.	☐
X3	Press Generate now on a regular report.	A spreadsheet downloads, and the notice gives the number of rows.	☐
X4	Open the sheet for one manager.	Only that manager's tenants, by dormitory.	☐
X5	In Email a report, tick a recipient with a test address and press Send with the workbook.	The email and its spreadsheet arrive. The Activity Log shows "Sent a report".	☐

13.10 Settings

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
G1	Open Settings, Mailbox.	"Test addresses only". One mailbox marked "Sends the 9am reminders", and no red problem line.	☐
G2	Send a test to a test inbox.	"Test sent", and it arrives from MES Group AR.	☐

G3	Send a test to an address that is not a test inbox.	"Nothing was sent", with the reason. Nothing arrives.	☐
G4	On Reminder timing, type 30 as the first reminder without saving.	The worked example changes. Change it back.	☐
G5	Type a final notice smaller than the first reminder.	"Cannot save".	☐
G6	Change a setting, save, then change it back and save.	Two entries in the Activity Log, each with your name.	☐
G7	On Report recipients, type a test address for one recipient and press Enter.	"Ready" beside it, and the same address on Reports and Export.	☐
G8	Open Charge types.	The rules, read only, ending with Other Charges.	☐

13.11 User Management and the Activity Log

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
A1	Add a login for a test person as CSD Officer.	"Login created for" their name. They can sign in with the first password.	☐
A2	Change their role to Relationship Manager and choose a manager.	"is now Relationship Manager". Signed in, they see only that manager's tenants.	☐
A3	Try to change your own role.	The role drop-down on your own row is greyed out.	☐
A4	Switch the test login off.	"Switched off". They can no longer sign in.	☐
L1	Open the Activity Log and press each filter in turn.	Only that kind of entry each time.	☐
L2	Find the actions from these tests.	Each one, with who did it and when.	☐

13.12 On a phone

#	Do this	You should see	Pass
P1	Sign in on a phone and open the menu.	The full menu for your role.	☐
P2	Open Call List and log a call.	The call window fits the screen and saves.	☐
P3	Open Outstanding Balances and a tenant's page.	Nothing runs off the side of the screen.	☐

14 Going live checklist

These are the steps to move from testing to sending real letters to real tenants, in order. Some are done in the system by an MES Admin. Others are done once by the system administrator in the hosting settings, and are marked as such. Do not switch sending on (step 5.1) until every step before it is done.

14.1 Before anything else

#	Step	Who	Done
1.1	Set sending to "Nothing is sent" while everything else is set up.	System administrator	☐
1.2	Make sure the Microsoft connection is in place, so Sign in with Microsoft works. Settings, Mailbox must not say "Microsoft sign in has not been set up".	System administrator	☐
1.3	If MES's Microsoft 365 only lets IT approve new apps, have MES's IT administrator approve MES AR Automation for the organisation.	MES IT	☐

14.2 Clearing the test data

#	Step	Who	Done
2.1	Clear the test letters, calls, promises, fees, edited letters and 9am run history, so the first live month starts clean.	System administrator	☐
2.2	Switch off or remove the test logins on User Management.	MES Admin	☐
2.3	Create a login for each person at MES, with the right role. Relationship Managers need their manager chosen (chapter 10).	MES Admin	☐

14.3 Connecting MES's mailbox

#	Step	Who	Done
3.1	Sign in, open Settings, Mailbox, press Sign in with Microsoft, and sign in as the AR team mailbox (section 9.3).	MES Admin	☐
3.2	Press Use for 9am reminders on that mailbox, so it is marked "Sends the 9am reminders".	MES Admin	☐
3.3	Press Disconnect on every test mailbox.	MES Admin	☐
3.4	Set sending to "Test addresses only", with a few MES staff addresses as the test list.	System administrator	☐
3.5	Send a test to one of those addresses and reply to it. The test arrives from MES Group AR, and the reply reaches the AR mailbox.	MES Admin	☐

14.4 Loading the real data

#	Step	Who	Done
4.1	Upload the current AR report from NetSuite and the real client contact list, read the checks, and press Use this report (chapter 3).	MES Admin or CSD	☐
4.2	Fill in every address on Settings, Report recipients.	MES Admin	☐
4.3	Check Reminder timing and Fees and reports hold the numbers MES wants.	MES Admin	☐
4.4	Open Reminder Emails, All tenants, and check the reminder dates of a few tenants you know.	MES Admin or CSD	☐

14.5 Switching sending on

#	Step	Who	Done
5.1	Set sending to "Sending to real tenants".	System administrator	☐
5.2	Check Settings, Mailbox reads "Sending to real tenants", with the AR mailbox as the sender and no problem line.	MES Admin	☐
5.3	The next morning, after 9am, open Activity Log, 9am runs, and Reminder Emails, Sent. The letters due that day went, from the AR mailbox.	MES Admin or CSD	☐

14.6 The first live month

- Check the 9am runs tab each morning for the first week, and Needs attention every day.
- Watch the AR mailbox for replies and bounced emails. A bounce usually means an address in the contact list is wrong: correct it and upload the list again.
- On the 16th, check the fees raised on Late Payment Fees and download the listing for the AR team.
- Upload a new report after each billing run, as in chapter 3.

FOR THE SYSTEM ADMINISTRATOR

The sending mode is the hosting setting `MAIL_MODE`: `off`, `allowed` (test addresses only, listed in `MAIL_ALLOWLIST`) or `everyone`. The Microsoft connection is `MICROSOFT_CLIENT_ID`, `MICROSOFT_CLIENT_SECRET` and `MICROSOFT_TENANT`, with `https://mes-ar-automation.vercel.app/api/mail/microsoft/callback` registered as the redirect address. A change to any of these takes effect after the site is redeployed.

REFERENCE

15 Glossary and common questions

15.1 Glossary

Term	Meaning
9am run	The work the system does on its own every morning at 9am Singapore time: letters due that day, and the late fees on the 16th.
Ad hoc	A bill dated on any day other than MES's regular billing day, the 15th.
AR report	The accounts receivable export from NetSuite that everything is worked out from.
Aging	Money grouped by how old it is: Current, 30 days, 60 days, 90 days, More than 90 days.
Billing date	The date a bill was raised, from the Date column of the AR report. Each one starts its own reminder clock.
By hand	A letter for a tenant with no email address, posted from Outlook by an officer.
Chaseable	Money more than 15 days past its due date.
Due date	When payment was due: from the report, or 14 days after billing.
Final notice	The second letter, 37 days after billing as standard.
First reminder	The first letter, 23 days after billing as standard.
GIRO tenant	A tenant who pays by GIRO, recognised by a Rejected GIRO Fee line in the report. Never charged the late fee.
Held back	A letter written but not sent, for example in test mode. It is recorded with the reason.
In credit	A tenant who has paid more than they owe. Never chased.
Late payment fee	S$100 before GST, raised on the 16th for bills more than 14 days past due.
Overdue	Money 30 days old or more.
Promise to pay	A tenant's commitment to pay an amount by a date. Holds their letters until then.
Report in use	The AR report every screen and the 9am run are reading.
Words in double braces	Parts of a letter filled in on the day it goes: {{company}}, {{code}}, {{property}}, {{amount}}, {{overdue}}, {{today}} and {{dueBy}}.

15.2 Common questions

A tenant says they never got their reminder.

Open Reminder Emails, Sent, and search for the tenant. If the letter is there, open it to see the address it went to and when. If it says "not sent", the Activity Log, 9am runs tab has the reason. If there is no letter, check All tenants: the bill may not have reached its day yet, or the tenant may have a promise or no email address.

Nothing went out this morning.

Open Settings, Mailbox. The line at the top says why: sending is off, the mailbox needs reconnecting, or no mailbox is connected. Then look at Needs attention on the Activity Log, which has a button to send the missed letters once the cause is fixed.

A tenant has paid but is still being chased.

The system knows a tenant has paid only from a newer AR report. Upload the current report from NetSuite and they drop off the letters and the Call List.

A tenant was charged a late fee they should not have been.

Check Late Payment Fees and the tenant's page for the bills the fee was for. Fees are billed in NetSuite from the listing, so correct it there. If the cause is a GIRO tenant without a Rejected GIRO Fee line, tell the system administrator.

The numbers look wrong after an upload.

Check Report in use on Upload Reports is the file you meant, and its date. If not, upload the right file. It replaces the wrong one and nothing else is lost.

Someone has forgotten their password.

Ask the system administrator to reset it.

Someone has left MES.

Switch their login off on User Management. If their mailbox was the one sending the 9am reminders, connect another mailbox and press Use for 9am reminders first.

15.3 Getting help

When reporting a problem, say what you were doing, which screen, the tenant if there was one, the time, and what you saw. A screenshot helps. Most problems can be traced from the Activity Log, so the time matters most.